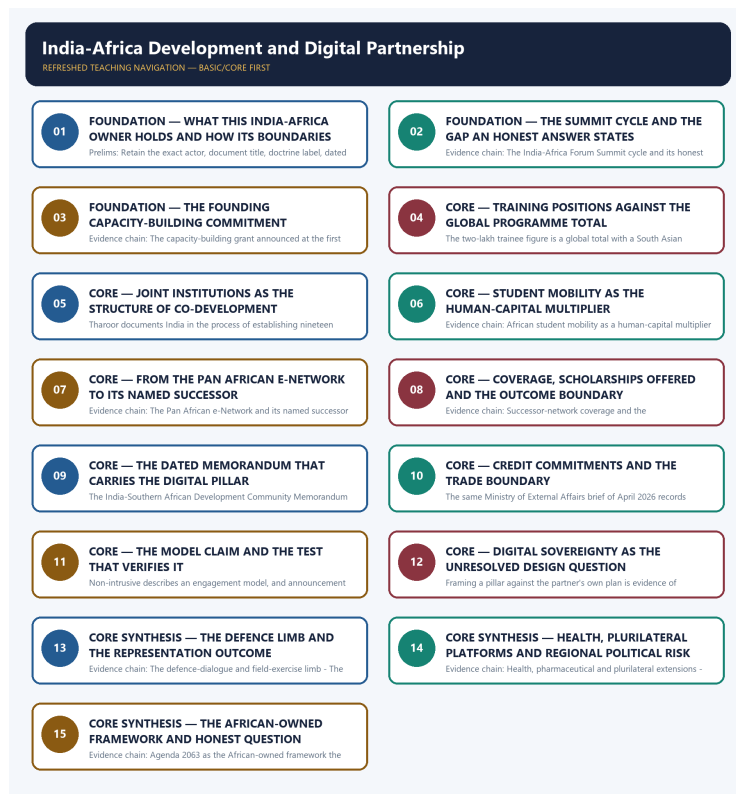


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

India-Africa Development and Digital Partnership - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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India-Africa Development and Digital Partnership - Learner-v2 Complete Learning Session

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-03. No PDF was rendered and no tracker or index was mutated.

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT

- **Generation date:** 2026-09-03.
- **Repository-first evidence:** the Basic owner is taught first and preserved in full; the Advanced owner is retained only in the optional final teaching block.
- **OCR evidence:** Repository Markdown was primary. The OCR-searchable official General Studies question papers held under books\mains and books\more_previous_papers were read only to confirm the printed wording of routed demands. No official answer key, marking scheme, page precision or unsupported quotation was imported from them.
- **Qdrant:** not used; repository Markdown and available OCR context were sufficient.
- **PYQ integrity:** Two General Studies Paper II Mains demands are routed to this topic in the audited routing ledgers and each is reproduced below as a demand card with its printed year, paper, question number, directive, marks and word limit exactly as the ledger records them: 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words, for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership; and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic. Two objective demands are also routed to this owner and are carried as coverage requirements only: 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally; and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally and its presence is recorded without being used. No option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. The locally held OCR-searchable official General Studies papers were read only to confirm the printed wording of the routed Mains demands; no question was invented from them, no stem was paraphrased into an apparent routing, and no marking scheme or official answer key was imported.
- **Live-link boundary:** Live official verification was attempted on 2026-09-03 in the priority order required for this topic: the Ministry of External Affairs pages first, then the Press Information Bureau, then the African Union as the partner multilateral institution. Every outcome is recorded exactly as observed. The Ministry of External Affairs press-release, bilateral-document, country-brief and India-Africa Forum Summit pages returned a browser-requirement stub or the Ministry's own error page, and the Press Information Bureau index returned HTTP 403, so no Indian official item was obtained. The African Union Agenda 2063 overview page did return substantive official text, and it is used here only for the African-owned framework facts it actually states; the African Union document page returned an unrelated climate-forum summary and supplied nothing to this package. The package therefore uses the dated official anchors already carried by the repository owners, each with its actor, exact evidentiary level and date, together with the African Union text just described. It invents no aid, grant or line-of-credit figure, no disbursement or project status, no digital-partnership deployment, coverage or scholarship count, no summit outcome, no memorandum or declaration wording, no institution count, no trade figure, no defence or security development, no date, no previous-year question, no answer key and no current claim.
- **Fact/inference discipline:** no current-affairs item, PYQ wording, figure or quotation is invented.

LIVE OFFICIAL-SOURCE ATTEMPT LOG

Every live check below was attempted on 2026-09-03 in the priority order required for International Relations: Ministry of External Affairs official pages first, then other official government or international-organisation documents. Access failures are recorded exactly as observed and no claim is reconstructed from a failed fetch.

- <https://www.mea.gov.in/press-releases.htm> - attempted 2026-09-03; the request redirected to a browser-requirement stub and returned no press release text, so no live item was taken from it.
- <https://www.mea.gov.in/bilateral-documents.htm> - attempted 2026-09-03; the request redirected to a browser-requirement stub and returned no bilateral document text, so no live item was taken from it.
- <https://www.mea.gov.in/foreign-relation.htm> - attempted 2026-09-03; the request redirected to the Ministry's own error page, so no country brief was taken from it.
- <https://www.pib.gov.in/indexd.aspx?reg=3&lang=1> - attempted 2026-09-03; the request returned HTTP 403, so no release was taken from it.
- <https://www.mea.gov.in/india-africa-forum-summit-2015.htm> - attempted 2026-09-03; the request redirected to the Ministry's own error page, so no summit record, declaration text or framework-of-cooperation wording was taken from it and the repository owners' dated summit list was used unchanged.
- <https://au.int/en/agenda2063/overview> - attempted 2026-09-03; the African Union returned substantive official text on Agenda 2063, its 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration of May 2013, its Pan-African Vision wording, its 2013 to 2063 horizon and its ten-year implementation plans. That text is used only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested; no India-Africa project, figure, credit line or outcome was taken from it.
- <https://au.int/en/documents> - attempted 2026-09-03; the African Union document page returned only an executive summary of the 21st African Continental Climate Outlook Forum held from 15 to 19 June 2026 in Lusaka, which is not an India-Africa partnership record, so no India-Africa instrument, summit outcome or figure was taken from it.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

Control	Binding rule for this package
Syllabus boundary	Complete International Relations Basic/Core is answer-complete before optional Advanced depth.
Status boundary	Announced, negotiated, initialled, signed, ratified, entered into force, operational, suspended and completed remain distinct.
Institutional method	Treaty basis or political character -> exact membership/status -> mandate -> decision rule -> national instrument -> implementation -> outcome.
Level mapping	Bilateral, subregional/regional, minilateral/plurilateral and systemic levels are separated and then connected.
Policy method	Strategic objective -> chosen instrument -> implementing actors/resources -> observed output/outcome -> alternative and residual risk.
Evidence method	Claim -> named India-centric treaty, institution, corridor, operation, agreement or summit -> analysis -> official source/date/status and causal qualification.
Neutrality method	Contested borders, maritime claims and conflicts are attributed neutrally; policy doctrine is distinguished from retrospective analytical label.
Practice contract	Every solved item has demand decoding, a detailed examiner-grade model, executable timed/compression plan, marks rationale and answer-specific improvement.
Approval	This immutable successor remains approved: false pending explicit approval.

Canonical Basic/Core owner: upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\International-Relations\basic\07_India-Africa-Development-and-Digital-Partnership.md **Substantive canonical provenance owner:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\International-Relations\07_India-Africa-Development-and-Digital-Partnersh

ip_Learner-V2-Complete-Topic-Package.md **Optional Advanced owner:** upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\International-Relations\advanced\07_India-Africa-Development-and-Digital-Partnership.md
Official syllabus mapping: upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\International Relations\OFFICIAL-UPSC-SYLLABUS-MAPPING.md

EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL

- **Membership discipline:** member, observer, dialogue partner, chair, guest and invited participant are not interchangeable; verify the relevant date.
- **Mandate discipline:** treaty organisation, UN organ, specialised agency, court, summit process, political forum, coalition and minilateral retain exact legal character and competence.
- **Agreement discipline:** announcement, negotiation, signature, ratification, entry into force, domestic implementation and measured outcome remain separate.
- **Connectivity discipline:** concept, financing, contract, construction, trial movement, operational segment, completed corridor and commercially viable use remain separate.
- **Conflict discipline:** distinguish verified event, party claim, independent attribution, legal characterisation and analytical inference; use neutral language for contested borders and conflicts.
- **Causal discipline:** chronology, summit language, trade change, deployment or project completion does not alone establish strategic effect; state mechanism, counterfactual and alternatives.
- **Trade-off discipline:** interests, capabilities, constraints, partner agency, escalation, dependence, finance, legitimacy, domestic distribution, alternatives and implementation risks are explicit.
- **PYQ discipline:** exact wording is preserved only where verified; routed or reconstructed demands remain labelled and no model is presented as an official UPSC answer.
- **Current-status note, rechecked 2026-09-03:** volatile relations, agreements, corridors, operations, conflicts, trade and summit outcomes retain official source, publication date and operative/interim/completed status; stale officeholders are omitted.

Generation-local live/current sources:

- <https://www.mea.gov.in/press-releases.htm> - attempted 2026-09-03; the request redirected to a browser-requirement stub and returned no press release text, so no live item was taken from it.
- <https://www.mea.gov.in/bilateral-documents.htm> - attempted 2026-09-03; the request redirected to a browser-requirement stub and returned no bilateral document text, so no live item was taken from it.
- <https://www.mea.gov.in/foreign-relation.htm> - attempted 2026-09-03; the request redirected to the Ministry's own error page, so no country brief was taken from it.
- <https://www.pib.gov.in/indexd.aspx?reg=3&lang=1> - attempted 2026-09-03; the request returned HTTP 403, so no release was taken from it.
- <https://www.mea.gov.in/india-africa-forum-summit-2015.htm> - attempted 2026-09-03; the request redirected to the Ministry's own error page, so no summit record, declaration text or framework-of-cooperation wording was taken from it and the repository owners' dated summit list was used unchanged.
- <https://au.int/en/agenda2063/overview> - attempted 2026-09-03; the African Union returned substantive official text on Agenda 2063, its 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration of May 2013, its Pan-African Vision wording, its 2013 to 2063 horizon and its ten-year implementation plans. That text is used only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested; no India-Africa project, figure, credit line or outcome was taken from it.
- <https://au.int/en/documents> - attempted 2026-09-03; the African Union document page returned only an executive summary of the 21st African Continental Climate Outlook Forum held from 15 to 19 June 2026 in Lusaka, which is not an India-Africa partnership record, so no India-Africa instrument, summit outcome or figure was

taken from it.



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - WHAT THIS INDIA-AFRICA OWNER HOLDS AND HOW ITS BOUNDARIES ARE ROUTED

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: What this India-Africa owner holds and how its boundaries are routed
Qualified use: Open an Africa demand by fixing ownership so the answer does not drift into another owner's evidence.

Technical definition: Prelims: Retain the exact actor, document title, doctrine label, dated instrument and evidentiary level attached to What this India-Africa owner holds and how its boundaries are routed, and never upgrade a vision statement into a treaty, a signature into a ratification, a participation category into membership, or an announced corridor into an operating one.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: What this India-Africa owner holds and how its boundaries are routed
Qualified use: Open an Africa demand by fixing ownership so the answer does not drift into another owner's evidence.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- What this India-Africa owner holds
- how its boundaries are routed
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- This

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define What this India-Africa owner holds, connect how its boundaries are routed with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

WHAT THIS INDIA-AFRICA OWNER HOLDS AND HOW ITS BOUNDARIES ARE ROUTED

01. What this India-Africa owner holds and how its boundaries are routed

BOUNDARY -> Trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to Economy, representation framing to topic 08, diaspora instruments to topic 09 and African colonial chronology to World History.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to Economy, representation framing to topic 08, diaspora instruments to topic 09 and African colonial chronology to World History.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, document title, doctrine label, dated instrument and evidentiary level attached to What this India-Africa owner holds and how its boundaries are routed, and never upgrade a vision statement into a treaty, a signature into a ratification, a participation category into membership, or an announced corridor into an operating one.
- **Mains:** Open an Africa demand by fixing ownership so the answer does not drift into another owner's evidence.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** What this India-Africa owner holds and how its boundaries are routed
- **Qualified use:** Open an Africa demand by fixing ownership so the answer does not drift into another owner's evidence.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - WHAT THIS INDIA-AFRICA OWNER HOLDS AND HOW ITS BOUNDARIES ARE ROUTED

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - What this India-Africa owner holds and how its boundaries are routed

|
v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • What this India-Africa owner holds • how its boundaries are routed •
Evidence chain • Qualified use • This

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Prelims: Retain the exact actor, document title, doctrine label, dated instrument and evidentiary level attached to What this India-Africa owner holds and how its boundaries are routed, and never upgrade a vision statement into a treaty, a signature into a ratification, a participation category into membership, or an announced corridor into an operating one.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Mains: Open an Africa demand by fixing ownership so the answer does not drift into another owner's evidence.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: What this India-Africa owner holds and how its boundaries are routed Qualified use: Open an Africa demand by fixing ownership so the answer does not drift into another owner's evidence.

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - THE SUMMIT CYCLE AND THE GAP AN HONEST ANSWER STATES

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: The India-Africa Forum Summit cycle and its honest gap Qualified use: Score by stating the architecture gap that most answers silently paper over.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: The India-Africa Forum Summit cycle and its honest gap Qualified use: Score by stating the architecture gap that most answers silently paper over.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- The summit cycle
- the gap an honest answer states
- Evidence chain

- **Qualified use**
- **The India-Africa Forum Summit**

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define The summit cycle, connect the gap an honest answer states with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE SUMMIT CYCLE AND THE GAP AN HONEST ANSWER STATES

01. The India-Africa Forum Summit cycle and its honest gap

BOUNDARY -> A summit announced and then postponed is not a summit held, and the gap after 2015 is a fact rather than an embarrassment to hide.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- A summit announced and then postponed is not a summit held, and the gap after 2015 is a fact rather than an embarrassment to hide.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, document title, doctrine label, dated instrument and evidentiary level attached to The summit cycle and the gap an honest answer states, and never upgrade a vision statement into a treaty, a signature into a ratification, a participation category into membership, or an announced corridor into an operating one.
- **Mains:** Score by stating the architecture gap that most answers silently paper over.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The India-Africa Forum Summit cycle and its honest gap
- **Qualified use:** Score by stating the architecture gap that most answers silently paper over.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - THE SUMMIT CYCLE AND THE GAP AN HONEST ANSWER STATES

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - The summit cycle and the gap an honest answer states

|
v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • The summit cycle • the gap an honest answer states • Evidence chain • Qualified use • The India-Africa Forum Summit

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: A summit announced and then postponed is not a summit held, and the gap after 2015 is a fact rather than an embarrassment to hide.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the India-Africa Forum Summit cycle and its honest gap Qualified use.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: The India-Africa Forum Summit cycle and its honest gap Qualified use: Score by stating the architecture gap that most answers silently paper over.

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - THE FOUNDING CAPACITY-BUILDING COMMITMENT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: An announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: The capacity-building grant announced at the first summit Qualified use: Establish the human-capital model with its founding figure without converting a commitment into delivered spending.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- The founding capacity-building commitment
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Tharoor
- India-Africa Forum Summit India

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define The founding capacity-building commitment, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Tharoor for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE FOUNDING CAPACITY-BUILDING COMMITMENT

01. The capacity-building grant announced at the first summit

BOUNDARY -> An announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- An announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, document title, doctrine label, dated instrument and evidentiary level attached to The founding capacity-building commitment, and never upgrade a vision statement into a treaty, a signature into a ratification, a participation category into membership, or an announced corridor into an operating one.
- **Mains:** Establish the human-capital model with its founding figure without converting a commitment into delivered spending.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The capacity-building grant announced at the first summit
- **Qualified use:** Establish the human-capital model with its founding figure without converting a commitment into delivered spending.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - THE FOUNDING CAPACITY-BUILDING COMMITMENT

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - The founding capacity-building commitment

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · The founding capacity-building commitment · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Tharoor · India-Africa Forum Summit India

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: The capacity-building grant announced at the first summit
Qualified use: Establish the human-capital model with its founding figure without converting a commitment into delivered spending.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: An announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure.

SESSION 4 - CORE - TRAINING POSITIONS AGAINST THE GLOBAL PROGRAMME TOTAL

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point.

Technical definition: The two-lakh trainee figure is a global total with a South Asian emphasis and is never an Africa-specific number.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Training positions against the global programme total
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Tharoor
- India's

- 2025-26

How to use them: Frame the answer through Training positions against the global programme total; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Tharoor to explain the mechanism, and use India's for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

TRAINING POSITIONS AGAINST THE GLOBAL PROGRAMME TOTAL

01. Training positions and the technical-cooperation boundary

BOUNDARY -> The two-lakh trainee figure is a global total with a South Asian emphasis and is never an Africa-specific number.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The two-lakh trainee figure is a global total with a South Asian emphasis and is never an Africa-specific number.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, document title, doctrine label, dated instrument and evidentiary level attached to Training positions against the global programme total, and never upgrade a vision statement into a treaty, a signature into a ratification, a participation category into membership, or an announced corridor into an operating one.
- **Mains:** Avoid the single most common numerical substitution error in answers on this topic.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Training positions and the technical-cooperation boundary
- **Qualified use:** Avoid the single most common numerical substitution error in answers on this topic.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - TRAINING POSITIONS AGAINST THE GLOBAL PROGRAMME TOTAL

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Training positions against the global programme total

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Training positions against the global programme total • Evidence chain • Qualified use

• Tharoor • India's • 2025-26

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Training positions and the technical-cooperation boundary
Qualified use: Avoid the single most common numerical substitution error in answers on this topic.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The two-lakh trainee figure is a global total with a South Asian emphasis and is never an Africa-specific number.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point.

SESSION 5 - CORE - JOINT INSTITUTIONS AS THE STRUCTURE OF CO-DEVELOPMENT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Nineteen institutions are substantive but do not amount to coverage across all fifty-four African states.

Technical definition: Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Joint institutions as the structure of co-development
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Tharoor
- India

- African

How to use them: Frame the answer through Joint institutions as the structure of co-development; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Tharoor to explain the mechanism, and use India for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

JOINT INSTITUTIONS AS THE STRUCTURE OF CO-DEVELOPMENT

01. The nineteen jointly established institutions

BOUNDARY -> Nineteen institutions are substantive but do not amount to coverage across all fifty-four African states.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Nineteen institutions are substantive but do not amount to coverage across all fifty-four African states.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, document title, doctrine label, dated instrument and evidentiary level attached to Joint institutions as the structure of co-development, and never upgrade a vision statement into a treaty, a signature into a ratification, a participation category into membership, or an announced corridor into an operating one.
- **Mains:** Evidence institutional partnership through joint governance rather than through a list of announcements.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The nineteen jointly established institutions
- **Qualified use:** Evidence institutional partnership through joint governance rather than through a list of announcements.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - JOINT INSTITUTIONS AS THE STRUCTURE OF CO-DEVELOPMENT

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Joint institutions as the structure of co-development

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Joint institutions as the structure of co-development • Evidence chain • Qualified use
• Tharoor • India • African

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: The nineteen jointly established institutions Qualified use:
Evidence institutional partnership through joint governance rather than through a list of
announcements.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Nineteen institutions are substantive but do not amount to coverage across
all fifty-four African states.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: tharoor documents India in the
process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen
institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states,
including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign
Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa
Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners
treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural
feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they
add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four
African states.

SESSION 6 - CORE - STUDENT MOBILITY AS THE HUMAN-CAPITAL MULTIPLIER

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: African student mobility as a human-capital multiplier Qualified use: Add the education-diplomacy channel with a correctly qualified figure instead of a rounded claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: African student mobility as a human-capital multiplier Qualified use: Add the education-diplomacy channel with a correctly qualified figure instead of a rounded claim.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Student mobility as the human-capital multiplier
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Tharoor notes that at any time there
- Tharoor
- African

How to use them: Frame the answer through Student mobility as the human-capital multiplier; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Tharoor notes that at any time there to explain the mechanism, and use Tharoor for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

STUDENT MOBILITY AS THE HUMAN-CAPITAL MULTIPLIER

01. African student mobility as a human-capital multiplier

BOUNDARY -> A standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- A standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, document title, doctrine label, dated instrument and evidentiary level attached to Student mobility as the human-capital multiplier, and never upgrade a vision statement into a treaty, a signature into a ratification, a participation category into membership, or an announced corridor into an operating one.
- **Mains:** Add the education-diplomacy channel with a correctly qualified figure instead of a rounded claim.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** African student mobility as a human-capital multiplier
- **Qualified use:** Add the education-diplomacy channel with a correctly qualified figure instead of a rounded claim.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - STUDENT MOBILITY AS THE HUMAN-CAPITAL MULTIPLIER

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Student mobility as the human-capital multiplier

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Student mobility as the human-capital multiplier · Evidence chain · Qualified use ·
Tharoor notes that at any time there · Tharoor · African

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: A standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: african student mobility as a human-capital multiplier Qualified use.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: African student mobility as a human-capital multiplier
Qualified use: Add the education-diplomacy channel with a correctly qualified figure instead of a rounded claim.

SESSION 7 - CORE - FROM THE PAN AFRICAN E-NETWORK TO ITS NAMED SUCCESSOR

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: The Pan African e-Network and its named successor Qualified use: Answer the 2025 digital demand through a dated succession rather than a generic digital-partnership assertion.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Tharoor
- Pan African
- Network
- Ministry

How to use them: Frame the answer through Evidence chain; define Qualified use, connect Tharoor with Pan African to explain the mechanism, and use Network for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

FROM THE PAN AFRICAN E-NETWORK TO ITS NAMED SUCCESSOR

01. The Pan African e-Network and its named successor

BOUNDARY -> The older network is a historical precursor concluded in 2017 and must not be described as the current flagship platform.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The older network is a historical precursor concluded in 2017 and must not be described as the current flagship platform.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, document title, doctrine label, dated instrument and evidentiary level attached to From the Pan African e-Network to its named successor, and never upgrade a vision statement into a treaty, a signature into a ratification, a participation category into membership, or an announced corridor into an operating one.
- **Mains:** Answer the 2025 digital demand through a dated succession rather than a generic digital-partnership assertion.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The Pan African e-Network and its named successor
- **Qualified use:** Answer the 2025 digital demand through a dated succession rather than a generic digital-partnership assertion.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - FROM THE PAN AFRICAN E-NETWORK TO ITS NAMED SUCCESSOR

START / CONCEPT: CORE - From the Pan African e-Network to its named successor

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Evidence chain • Qualified use • Tharoor • Pan African • Network • Ministry

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: The Pan African e-Network and its named successor Qualified use: Answer the 2025 digital demand through a dated succession rather than a generic digital-partnership assertion.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The older network is a historical precursor concluded in 2017 and must not be described as the current flagship platform.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current.

SESSION 8 - CORE - COVERAGE, SCHOLARSHIPS OFFERED AND THE OUTCOME BOUNDARY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Scholarships offered measures reach and is not the same as completed training, employment or delivered infrastructure.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Successor-network coverage and the offered-versus-completed line Qualified use: Convert a headline count into an evidentiary-level statement, which is where the analytical marks sit.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Scholarships offered measures reach and is not the same as completed training, employment or delivered infrastructure.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Coverage
- scholarships offered
- the outcome boundary
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Scholarships offered measures reach and

How to use them: Frame the answer through Coverage; define scholarships offered, connect the outcome boundary with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

COVERAGE, SCHOLARSHIPS OFFERED AND THE OUTCOME BOUNDARY

01. Successor-network coverage and the offered-versus-completed line

BOUNDARY -> Scholarships offered measures reach and is not the same as completed training, employment or delivered infrastructure.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Scholarships offered measures reach and is not the same as completed training, employment or delivered infrastructure.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, document title, doctrine label, dated instrument and evidentiary level attached to Coverage, scholarships offered and the outcome boundary, and never upgrade a vision statement into a treaty, a signature into a ratification, a participation category into membership, or an announced corridor into an operating one.
- **Mains:** Convert a headline count into an evidentiary-level statement, which is where the analytical marks sit.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Successor-network coverage and the offered-versus-completed line
- **Qualified use:** Convert a headline count into an evidentiary-level statement, which is where the analytical marks sit.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - COVERAGE, SCHOLARSHIPS OFFERED AND THE OUTCOME BOUNDARY

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Coverage, scholarships offered and the outcome boundary

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Coverage · scholarships offered · the outcome boundary · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Scholarships offered measures reach and

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Successor-network coverage and the offered-versus-completed line Qualified use: Convert a headline count into an evidentiary-level statement, which is where the analytical marks sit.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Mains: Convert a headline count into an evidentiary-level statement, which is where the analytical marks sit.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: scholarships offered measures reach and is not the same as completed training, employment or...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Scholarships offered measures reach and is not the same as completed training, employment or delivered infrastructure.

SESSION 9 - CORE - THE DATED MEMORANDUM THAT CARRIES THE DIGITAL PILLAR

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: The India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 2 July 2024
Qualified use: Supply the current dated instrument a digital-partnership demand expects instead of an undated cooperation claim.

Technical definition: The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: The India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 2 July 2024
Qualified use: Supply the current dated instrument a digital-partnership demand expects instead of an undated cooperation claim.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- The dated memorandum that carries the digital pillar
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- The India-Southern African Development Community
- Memorandum
- 2020-2030

How to use them: Frame the answer through The dated memorandum that carries the digital pillar; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with The India-Southern African Development Community to explain the mechanism, and use Memorandum for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE DATED MEMORANDUM THAT CARRIES THE DIGITAL PILLAR

01. The India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 2 July 2024

BOUNDARY -> A memorandum states intent, and its entry into force and delivery require separate verification.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- A memorandum states intent, and its entry into force and delivery require separate verification.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, document title, doctrine label, dated instrument and evidentiary level attached to The dated memorandum that carries the digital pillar, and never upgrade a vision statement into a treaty, a signature into a ratification, a participation category into membership, or an announced corridor into an operating one.
- **Mains:** Supply the current dated instrument a digital-partnership demand expects instead of an undated cooperation claim.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 2 July 2024
- **Qualified use:** Supply the current dated instrument a digital-partnership demand expects instead of an undated cooperation claim.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - THE DATED MEMORANDUM THAT CARRIES THE DIGITAL PILLAR

START / CONCEPT: CORE - The dated memorandum that carries the digital pillar

|

v

EXACT TERMS: The dated memorandum that carries the digital pillar • Evidence chain • Qualified use
• The India-Southern African Development Community • Memorandum • 2020-2030

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that the India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 2 July 2024 Qualified use.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 2 July 2024 Qualified use.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: The India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 2 July 2024 Qualified use: Supply the current dated instrument a digital-partnership demand expects instead of an undated cooperation claim.

SESSION 10 - CORE - CREDIT COMMITMENTS AND THE TRADE BOUNDARY

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Extended credit is a commitment, and trade-volume mechanics belong to the Economy owner rather than to this answer.

Technical definition: The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Lines of credit as commitments rather than disbursements - India-Africa trade and the Economy boundary Qualified use: Use scale evidence at its true evidentiary level while keeping the answer inside its own syllabus emphasis.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Credit commitments
- the trade boundary
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- The Ministry
- 2024-25

How to use them: Frame the answer through Credit commitments; define the trade boundary, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use The Ministry for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

CREDIT COMMITMENTS AND THE TRADE BOUNDARY

01. Lines of credit as commitments rather than disbursements

|
v

02. India-Africa trade and the Economy boundary

BOUNDARY -> Extended credit is a commitment, and trade-volume mechanics belong to the Economy owner rather than to this answer.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number.
- The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Extended credit is a commitment, and trade-volume mechanics belong to the Economy owner rather than to this answer.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, document title, doctrine label, dated instrument and evidentiary level attached to Credit commitments and the trade boundary, and never upgrade a vision statement into a treaty, a signature into a ratification, a participation category into membership, or an announced corridor into an operating one.
- **Mains:** Use scale evidence at its true evidentiary level while keeping the answer inside its own syllabus emphasis.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Lines of credit as commitments rather than disbursements -> India-Africa trade and the Economy boundary
- **Qualified use:** Use scale evidence at its true evidentiary level while keeping the answer inside its own syllabus emphasis.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - CREDIT COMMITMENTS AND THE TRADE BOUNDARY

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Credit commitments and the trade boundary

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v

EXACT TERMS: Credit commitments · the trade boundary · Evidence chain · Qualified use · The Ministry · 2024-25

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Mains: Use scale evidence at its true evidentiary level while keeping the answer inside its own syllabus emphasis.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Lines of credit as commitments rather than disbursements - India-Africa trade and the Economy boundary Qualified use: Use scale evidence at its true evidentiary level while keeping the answer inside its own syllabus emphasis.

SESSION 11 - CORE - THE MODEL CLAIM AND THE TEST THAT VERIFIES IT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment.

Technical definition: Non-intrusive describes an engagement model, and announcement scale is never evidence of partnership depth.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- The model claim
- the test that verifies it
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Tharoor

- India's

How to use them: Frame the answer through The model claim; define the test that verifies it, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Tharoor for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE MODEL CLAIM AND THE TEST THAT VERIFIES IT

01. Demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development as the model claim

|
v

02. The implementation and maintenance test

BOUNDARY -> Non-intrusive describes an engagement model, and announcement scale is never evidence of partnership depth.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence. The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence.
- The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Non-intrusive describes an engagement model, and announcement scale is never evidence of partnership depth.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, document title, doctrine label, dated instrument and evidentiary level attached to The model claim and the test that verifies it, and never upgrade a vision statement into a treaty, a signature into a ratification, a participation category into membership, or an announced corridor into an operating one.
- **Mains:** Answer the mutual-respect and long-term limbs of the 2025 demand with a testable criterion rather than praise.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development as the model claim -> The implementation and maintenance test
- **Qualified use:** Answer the mutual-respect and long-term limbs of the 2025 demand with a testable criterion rather than praise.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - THE MODEL CLAIM AND THE TEST THAT VERIFIES IT

START / CONCEPT: CORE - The model claim and the test that verifies it

|

v

EXACT TERMS: The model claim · the test that verifies it · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Tharoor · India's

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development as the model claim - The implementation and maintenance test Qualified use: Answer the mutual-respect and long-term limbs of the 2025 demand with a testable criterion rather than praise.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Non-intrusive describes an engagement model, and announcement scale is never evidence of partnership depth.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence.

SESSION 12 - CORE - DIGITAL SOVEREIGNTY AS THE UNRESOLVED DESIGN QUESTION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice.

Technical definition: Framing a pillar against the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and not proof that control questions are settled.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Digital sovereignty as the unresolved design question
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use

- African
- India-SADC
- 2020-2030

How to use them: Frame the answer through Digital sovereignty as the unresolved design question; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with African to explain the mechanism, and use India-SADC for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

DIGITAL SOVEREIGNTY AS THE UNRESOLVED DESIGN QUESTION

01. Digital sovereignty as an unresolved design question

BOUNDARY -> Framing a pillar against the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and not proof that control questions are settled.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Framing a pillar against the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and not proof that control questions are settled.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, document title, doctrine label, dated instrument and evidentiary level attached to Digital sovereignty as the unresolved design question, and never upgrade a vision statement into a treaty, a signature into a ratification, a participation category into membership, or an announced corridor into an operating one.
- **Mains:** Add the qualification that separates a competent digital-partnership answer from a promotional one.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Digital sovereignty as an unresolved design question
- **Qualified use:** Add the qualification that separates a competent digital-partnership answer from a promotional one.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - DIGITAL SOVEREIGNTY AS THE UNRESOLVED DESIGN QUESTION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Digital sovereignty as the unresolved design question

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v

EXACT TERMS: Digital sovereignty as the unresolved design question • Evidence chain • Qualified use
• African • India-SADC • 2020-2030

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Digital sovereignty as an unresolved design question
Qualified use: Add the qualification that separates a competent digital-partnership answer from a promotional one.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Framing a pillar against the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and not proof that control questions are settled.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Mains: Add the qualification that separates a competent digital-partnership answer from a promotional one.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice.

SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - THE DEFENCE LIMB AND THE REPRESENTATION OUTCOME

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: The defence-dialogue and field-exercise limb - The African Union's permanent seat in the Group of Twenty Qualified use: Widen influence beyond development finance while keeping every claim at its real scale.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: The defence-dialogue and field-exercise limb - The African Union's permanent seat in the Group of Twenty Qualified use: Widen influence beyond development finance while keeping every claim at its real scale.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- The defence limb
- the representation outcome
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define The defence limb, connect the representation outcome with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE DEFENCE LIMB AND THE REPRESENTATION OUTCOME

01. The defence-dialogue and field-exercise limb

|

v

02. The African Union's permanent seat in the Group of Twenty

BOUNDARY -> Declarations and exercises are not capability transfer, and one forum's membership is not systemic reform.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation. The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation.
- The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Declarations and exercises are not capability transfer, and one forum's membership is not systemic reform.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, document title, doctrine label, dated instrument and evidentiary level attached to The defence limb and the representation outcome, and never upgrade a vision statement into a treaty, a signature into a ratification, a participation category into membership, or an announced corridor into an operating one.
- **Mains:** Widen influence beyond development finance while keeping every claim at its real scale.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The defence-dialogue and field-exercise limb -> The African Union's permanent seat in the Group of Twenty

- **Qualified use:** Widen influence beyond development finance while keeping every claim at its real scale.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - THE DEFENCE LIMB AND THE REPRESENTATION OUTCOME

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - The defence limb and the representation outcome

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · The defence limb · the representation outcome · Evidence chain · Qualified use · India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance.

|

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Declarations and exercises are not capability transfer, and one forum's membership is not systemic reform.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: The defence-dialogue and field-exercise limb - The African Union's permanent seat in the Group of Twenty Qualified use: Widen influence beyond development finance while keeping every claim at its real scale.

SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - HEALTH, PLURILATERAL PLATFORMS AND REGIONAL POLITICAL RISK

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Health, pharmaceutical and plurilateral extensions - Political risk in the Sahel and the comparator question Qualified use: Cover the two routed objective demands and supply the comparator paragraph a 20-mark assessment needs.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Health, pharmaceutical and plurilateral extensions - Political risk in the Sahel and the comparator question Qualified use: Cover the two routed objective demands and supply the comparator paragraph a 20-mark assessment needs.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Health
- plurilateral platforms
- regional political risk
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Health, connect plurilateral platforms with regional political risk to explain the mechanism, and use Evidence chain for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

HEALTH, PLURILATERAL PLATFORMS AND REGIONAL POLITICAL RISK

01. Health, pharmaceutical and plurilateral extensions

|

v

02. Political risk in the Sahel and the comparator question

BOUNDARY -> Membership is not delivery, and neither Sahel instability nor the competing partnership route may be generalised or caricatured.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims. Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims.
- Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on

China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Membership is not delivery, and neither Sahel instability nor the competing partnership route may be generalised or caricatured.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, document title, doctrine label, dated instrument and evidentiary level attached to Health, plurilateral platforms and regional political risk, and never upgrade a vision statement into a treaty, a signature into a ratification, a participation category into membership, or an announced corridor into an operating one.
- **Mains:** Cover the two routed objective demands and supply the comparator paragraph a 20-mark assessment needs.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Health, pharmaceutical and plurilateral extensions -> Political risk in the Sahel and the comparator question
- **Qualified use:** Cover the two routed objective demands and supply the comparator paragraph a 20-mark assessment needs.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - HEALTH, PLURILATERAL PLATFORMS AND REGIONAL POLITICAL RISK

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Health, plurilateral platforms and regional political risk

|

v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Health · plurilateral platforms · regional political risk · Evidence chain · Qualified use

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Membership is not delivery, and neither Sahel instability nor the competing partnership route may be generalised or caricatured.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Health, pharmaceutical and plurilateral extensions - Political risk in the Sahel and the comparator question Qualified use: Cover the two routed objective demands and supply the comparator paragraph a 20-mark assessment needs.

SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - THE AFRICAN-OWNED FRAMEWORK AND HONEST QUESTION OWNERSHIP

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Agenda 2063 as the African-owned framework the partnership must fit - Honest question ownership for this India-Africa owner Qualified use: Close by testing alignment against Africa's own plan and by stating the ownership boundary explicitly.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Agenda 2063 as the African-owned framework the partnership must fit - Honest question ownership for this India-Africa owner Qualified use: Close by testing alignment against Africa's own plan and by stating the ownership boundary explicitly.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- The African-owned framework
- honest question ownership
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Subject

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define The African-owned framework, connect honest question ownership with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE AFRICAN-OWNED FRAMEWORK AND HONEST QUESTION OWNERSHIP

01. Agenda 2063 as the African-owned framework the partnership must fit

|
v

02. Honest question ownership for this India-Africa owner

BOUNDARY -> The continental framework page supplies no India-specific figure, and no routed demand may be answered from an answer key.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it.
- The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The continental framework page supplies no India-specific figure, and no routed demand may be answered from an answer key.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, document title, doctrine label, dated instrument and evidentiary level attached to The African-owned framework and honest question ownership, and never upgrade a vision statement into a treaty, a signature into a ratification, a participation category into membership, or an announced corridor into an operating one.
- **Mains:** Close by testing alignment against Africa's own plan and by stating the ownership boundary explicitly.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Agenda 2063 as the African-owned framework the partnership must fit -> Honest question ownership for this India-Africa owner
- **Qualified use:** Close by testing alignment against Africa's own plan and by stating the ownership boundary explicitly.

COMPLETE BASIC OWNER EVIDENCE BANK

Subject: International Relations | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS Paper:** GS-II. **Core area:** India-Africa Forum Summit (IAFS); capacity building; lines of credit; health/education cooperation; digital public infrastructure (DPI). **Grounded in:** Shashi Tharoor, *Pax Indica*; MEA India-SADC Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation (2 July 2024) and MEA Africa background brief (April 2026); Economic Survey 2025-26 (ITEC); 00_Master-Framework.md Sections 2-3. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference | **CURRENT:** = current anchor. *Companion:* advanced/07_India-Africa-Development-and-Digital-Partnership.md.

1. Visual foundation

INDIA-AFRICA FORUM SUMMIT (IAFS)
political framework for the partnership
|
v
CAPACITY-BUILDING PILLAR
lines of credit + \$500 million HRD grant
(first IAFS) + 1600 technical-cooperation
training positions + joint institutions
|
v
EDUCATION AND STUDENT MOBILITY
10,000-15,000 African students in India
at any given time
|
v
DIGITAL PARTNERSHIP
Pan African e-Network (historical precursor,
concluded 2017) -> e-VBAB successor
|
v
CO-DEVELOPMENT PRINCIPLE
demand-driven, non-intrusive support to
African institutions and democratic systems
|
v
OUTCOME: MUTUAL RESPECT + LONG-TERM
INSTITUTIONAL PARTNERSHIP (2025 PYQ framing)

Core proposition: ANALYSIS: India's Africa partnership is built on human-capital investment (training, institutions, scholarships) and a digital-connectivity layer whose Pan African e-Network precursor was succeeded by e-VBAB, delivered through a demand-driven, co-development model rather than a donor-recipient framing.

2. Essential definitions

Concept	Exam-ready meaning
ANALYSIS: India-Africa Forum Summit (IAFS)	The principal political framework convening India and African states/the African Union for periodic summit-level engagement on development partnership. CURRENT: IAFS-I: New Delhi, 8-9 April 2008; IAFS-II: Addis Ababa, 24-25 May 2011; IAFS-III: New Delhi, 26-29 October 2015. IAFS-IV was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and, on 21 May 2026, India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation - ANALYSIS: announced and postponed, not held.
FACT: Pan African e-Network and e-VBAB	FACT: Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the "digital divide" through tele-education and ICT connectivity. MEA records that project as concluded in 2017; the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project (e-VBAB), for which the MEA-TCIL implementation agreement was signed on 10 September 2018 and which was launched in 2019, is its tele-education and tele-medicine successor. CURRENT: MEA records e-VBAB participation by 22 African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered (April 2026 brief). ANALYSIS: Scholarships offered is not the same as students who completed training.
FACT: Joint institution-building	FACT: Tharoor documents India "in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states," including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes.
FACT: Capacity-building grant	FACT: Tharoor: "at the first India-Africa Forum Summit, India announced a grant of \$500 million specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building."
FACT: Technical-cooperation training positions	FACT: Tharoor cites "1600 training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa."
ANALYSIS: Co-development / demand-driven partnership	The 2025 PYQ's framing - "mutual respect, co-development and long-term institutional partnerships" - describes a partnership model distinct from donor-driven aid, emphasising African agency in setting priorities.

3. How the India-Africa partnership mechanism works

- Summit-level political framework:** IAFS periodically convenes India and African leaders/the African Union to set the overall partnership direction.
- Capacity-building instruments:** FACT: the \$500 million HRD/capacity-building grant (first IAFS) and the 1600 technical-cooperation training positions operationalise the human-capital dimension of the partnership.
- Joint institutions embed capacity on African soil:** FACT: the nineteen jointly established institutions (IT, foreign trade, educational planning, diamond processing, vocational training, human settlements) create durable, in-country capacity rather than one-off training abroad.
- Student mobility deepens the human link:** FACT: Tharoor notes "at any time there are at least 10,000 to 15,000 African students studying in various parts of India" - a sustained education-diplomacy channel.
- Digital connectivity extends the reach:** FACT: the historical Pan African e-Network demonstrated the tele-education model; after it concluded in 2017, e-VBAB carried forward tele-education and tele-medicine cooperation, supporting the "digital partnership" framing of the 2025 PYQ.
- Co-development framing:** FACT: Tharoor frames the political-cooperation

dimension as "non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions" - a demand-driven, non-prescriptive posture distinguishing India's approach from more directive donor models.

4. Institutions and agreements

- CURRENT: **India-Africa Forum Summit (IAFS)**: the umbrella political mechanism - IAFS-I (New Delhi, 2008), IAFS-II (Addis Ababa, 2011), IAFS-III (New Delhi, 2015); IAFS-IV was announced on 23 April 2026 and postponed on 21 May 2026. ANALYSIS: The decade-long gap since IAFS-III is itself a legitimate analytical point about the pace of summit-level institutionalisation.
 - FACT: **Pan African e-Network**: historical digital-partnership precursor, concluded in 2017.
 - FACT: **e-VBAB**: the successor tele-education and tele-medicine network (MEA-TCIL implementation agreement 10 September 2018; launched 2019), with 22 participating African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered per MEA's April 2026 brief.
 - FACT: **Nineteen jointly established institutions** (IT, foreign trade, educational planning and administration, diamond processing, ten vocational training centres, five human settlement institutes) with the African Union Commission and member states.
 - CURRENT: ****India-SADC Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation**, signed 2 July 2024 **at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati. It frames cooperation against SADC's RISDP 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development**, new and emerging technologies (ICT development including connectivity, access and Digital Public Infrastructure)**, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation. It replaces/renews an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation MoU of 14 October 1997. ANALYSIS: An MoU is a statement of intent; entry into force and delivery require separate verification.
 - CURRENT: **Development-partnership scale (MEA, April 2026 Africa brief)**: more than **190 Lines of Credit** worth over **USD 10 billion** extended to **41 African countries**; India-Africa trade in FY2024-25 stood at **USD 81.99 billion**. ANALYSIS: Lines of credit *extended* are commitments, not disbursements.
 - FACT: **Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation (ITEC) Programme**: per the Economic Survey 2025-26, ITEC has "trained more than two lakh persons from over 160 countries in both the civilian and the defence sector," and is described as "an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region" - cite this as the broader technical-cooperation architecture within which Africa-specific training positions (the 1600 figure) sit, dated to the Economic Survey 2025-26.
- #### Security, representation and political-risk evidence
- FACT: **India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave**: the first conclave at Lucknow in **February 2020** adopted the Lucknow Declaration; the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in **October 2022** adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation. **Significance**: the relationship includes institutional defence dialogue, training and capacity building, not only development finance. **Limitation**: declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer.
 - FACT: **AFINDEX**: the Africa-India Field Training Exercise, held in India in 2019 and again in **March 2023**, provides a named peacekeeping and humanitarian-mine-action cooperation route. **Significance**: exercises build interoperability and training networks. **Limitation**: episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance.
 - ANALYSIS: **Maritime security**: Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean/Gulf of Aden support sea-lane security relevant to East African partners. **Significance**: it connects India's Indian Ocean role with African trade and coastal security. **Limitation**: African maritime priorities vary and local ownership must shape cooperation.
 - FACT: **Representation**: the African Union became a permanent G20 member at the

New Delhi Summit on **9 September 2023**. **Significance:** India translated partnership rhetoric into a concrete representation outcome. **Limitation:** G20 membership does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or UN-representation deficits.

- ANALYSIS: **Sahel instability:** coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020-23 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection. **Significance:** Africa policy must be region-specific and resilience-aware. **Limitation:** Sahel instability must not be generalised to the continent.

- ANALYSIS: **China/FOCAC comparator:** China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and infrastructure finance provide African states with another large-scale partnership route. **Significance:** India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects. **Limitation:** do not caricature Chinese engagement as uniformly extractive or assume African states passively choose between India and China; compare delivery, finance terms, local ownership and sector fit.

5. Indian applications and examples

- FACT: **Direct PYQ (2025 Q9):** *India-Africa digital partnership is achieving mutual respect, co-development and long-term institutional partnerships. Elaborate.* (150 words) - this is the anchor PYQ for this topic.

- FACT: A strong answer to 2025 Q9 should cite the Pan African e-Network as the historical precursor and e-VBAB as its successor, the nineteen joint institutions (institutional partnership), the \$500 million HRD grant and 1600 training positions (mutual-respect/capacity- building dimension), and the India-SADC MoU (2 July 2024, whose "new and emerging technologies" pillar covers ICT, connectivity, access and DPI) as the current dated evidence of continuing digital-partnership expansion, supported by MEA's April 2026 figures (190+ LoCs, over USD 10 billion, 41 countries; e-VBAB in 22 countries).

- ANALYSIS: The "mutual respect" framing is best evidenced by the demand-driven, non-intrusive model Tharoor describes, contrasted with a donor-imposed conditionality model.

- FACT: **CDRI as an additional partnership route:** India launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the UN Climate Action Summit on **23 September 2019**. Its member-country and partner-organisation network supports resilient-infrastructure knowledge and capacity. **Significance:** it extends India-Africa cooperation beyond credit and digital delivery into climate-resilient infrastructure. **Limitation:** membership and a global mission are not evidence that a particular African project has been delivered.

- FACT: **Health and telemedicine:** the Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine; its e-VBAB successor includes e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine. **Significance:** health cooperation builds continuing institutional access. **Limitation:** digital access and local health capacity determine use.

- ANALYSIS: **Pharmaceutical partnership:** affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links. **Significance:** pharma is a visible low-cost development good. **Limitation:** regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity must qualify celebratory claims.

- FACT: **International Solar Alliance:** the treaty-based ISA Framework Agreement entered into force on **6 December 2017** and its headquarters are in Gurugram, India. **Significance:** ISA gives African members a platform for solar-finance aggregation, capacity building and technology cooperation. **Limitation:** membership does not prove delivery of a particular project.

6. Must-Know Facts for Prelims

- FACT: India announced a \$500 million grant for human resource development and capacity building at the first India-Africa Forum Summit.

- FACT: India is establishing nineteen institutions jointly with the African Union Commission and African member states.

- FACT: The Pan African e-Network, which targeted the "digital divide" through tele-education, concluded in 2017; e-VBAB succeeded it from 2019.
- FACT: At any given time, 10,000-15,000 African students study in India.
- FACT: 1600 training positions are offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically.
- CURRENT: The India-SADC Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024; it explicitly covers ICT development, connectivity, access and Digital Public Infrastructure among ten cooperation areas, and renews an earlier India-SADC MoU of 14 October 1997.
- CURRENT: IAFS-I (2008), IAFS-II (2011) and IAFS-III (2015) have been held; IAFS-IV was announced on 23 April 2026 and postponed on 21 May 2026.
- CURRENT: MEA records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and India-Africa trade of USD 81.99 billion in FY2024-25.
- CURRENT: e-VBAB covers 22 African countries with 15,116 scholarships offered (MEA, April 2026).
- CURRENT: ITEC has trained more than two lakh persons from over 160 countries, per the Economic Survey 2025-26 (a global figure, not Africa-specific).

7. UPSC traps

- WRONG: India's Africa partnership is primarily a trade/investment relationship. -> The 2024-2025 syllabus emphasis and the retrieved sources foreground capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership; Economy owns bilateral trade-volume mechanics separately.
- WRONG: The Pan African e-Network remains India's ongoing flagship Africa digital platform. -> MEA records it as concluded in 2017; e-VBAB is the successor tele-education and tele-medicine network launched in 2019.
- WRONG: ITEC's 2-lakh-trainee figure (Economic Survey 2025-26) is Africa-specific. -> It is a global figure across 160+ countries with an explicit South Asian emphasis; the Africa-specific figure is the 1600 training positions cited separately by Tharoor.
- WRONG: India's Africa engagement is donor-driven, mirroring a traditional aid model. -> Tharoor frames it as "non-intrusive" and demand-driven, distinguishing it from a conditionality-based aid relationship.
- WRONG: MoUs with African regional bodies (e.g., SADC) equal delivered outcomes. -> An MoU states intent; delivery/implementation requires separate, dated verification (announcement-delivery gap).
- WRONG: The IAFS process has continued on a regular cycle. -> IAFS-III (2015) was the last summit held; IAFS-IV was announced on 23 April 2026 and postponed on 21 May 2026 - an honest acknowledgement of this gap strengthens rather than weakens an answer.
- WRONG: Lines of credit "extended" to Africa are the same as money disbursed. -> MEA's figure of 190+ LoCs worth over USD 10 billion across 41 countries measures commitments; disbursement and project completion are separate questions.

8. CURRENT: Current anchor

- CURRENT: The **India-SADC MoU on Economic Cooperation (2 July 2024)**, whose "new and emerging technologies" pillar expressly covers ICT development, connectivity, access and Digital Public Infrastructure, is the anchor current instrument for this topic's digital-partnership dimension - cite it, dated and by its exact title, for any claim about contemporary India-Africa digital cooperation.
- CURRENT: Pair it with the **MEA April 2026 Africa brief** figures (190+ LoCs, over

USD 10 billion, 41 countries; FY2024-25 trade of USD 81.99 billion; e-VBAB in 22 countries) as the dated quantitative backdrop, and note that **IAFS-IV was announced (23 April 2026) and postponed (21 May 2026)**.

9. PYQ application

- FACT: **2021 GS-II**: "If the last few decades were of Asia's growth story, the next few are expected to be of Africa's. In the light of this statement, examine India's influence in Africa in recent years." Structure by development partnership, trade/investment, capacity-building, diplomacy and implementation constraints; do not reduce the answer to digital cooperation.
- FACT: **2025 Q9 (direct)**: *India-Africa digital partnership is achieving mutual respect, co-development and long-term institutional partnerships. Elaborate.* Structure: (1) trace the Pan African e-Network (concluded 2017) to its e-VBAB successor (launched 2019); (2) cite the India-SADC MoU (2 July 2024, ICT/ connectivity/access/DPI pillar) as current evidence; (3) evidence "institutional partnership" via the nineteen jointly established institutions; (4) evidence "mutual respect/co-development" via the demand-driven, non-intrusive model and African student mobility; (5) avoid overstating continent-wide DPI rollout as completed.

10. Mains angles

- ANALYSIS: Evidence "digital partnership" with the Pan African e-Network-to-e-VBAB transition and a dated MoU (SADC, 2 July 2024), not a generic DPI claim.
- ANALYSIS: Distinguish capacity-building/institution-building from trade/investment
- this topic's syllabus emphasis is the former.
- ANALYSIS: Use "demand-driven" and "non-intrusive" as the precise vocabulary for "mutual respect" and "co-development."
- ANALYSIS: Cite the ITEC figure (Economic Survey 2025-26) only as global context, not as an Africa-specific figure.

Answer thesis: India's Africa partnership converts human-capital investment (training positions, joint institutions, scholarships) and digital connectivity (the historical Pan African e-Network and its e-VBAB successor, complemented by the 2024 SADC MoU's ICT/DPI provisions) into a demand-driven, non-intrusive model of cooperation - the structural basis for the "mutual respect, co-development and long-term institutional partnership" the 2025 PYQ describes.

11. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims**: How many institutions is India establishing jointly with the African Union Commission and African member states?
- FACT: **Mains (10 marks, direct 2025 PYQ)**: India-Africa digital partnership is achieving mutual respect, co-development and long-term institutional partnerships. Elaborate.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks)**: Assess the role of capacity-building and joint institution-building in sustaining India's partnership with Africa.

11A. Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

The **2021 GS-II India-in-Africa** demand is owned here, superseding advanced/07.

- **Evidence bank**: IAFS, Lines of Credit, ITEC, e-VBAB, digital public infrastructure, health/pharma, solar/CDRI, AU entry into G20 and maritime/security cooperation.
 - **Evaluation**: demand-driven capacity building and lower-cost technology strengthen partnership; delivery delay, thin commercial presence and competition from other powers qualify influence claims.
- 10 marks**: three partnership pillars and one constraint. **15 marks**: development, digital, trade, health, security and representation. **20 marks**: compare India's model with extractive/conditionality critiques, add African agency, regional diversity and project-outcome discipline.

Reasoned verdict: India's African influence depends on converting solidarity and training into timely, locally owned and commercially sustainable delivery.

12. Study links

- FACT: Advanced companion:
advanced/07_India-Africa-Development-and-Digital-Partnership.md.
- FACT: Economy/basic/24_Services-Digital-Economy-Fintech-and-Platform-Markets.md
- DPI/digital-economy mechanics (Economy owns broader digital-economy detail).
- ANALYSIS: **Cross-links within this folder:** topic 08 for Global South representation

framing; topic 09 for diaspora/ITEC as a soft-power instrument; World-History owns African colonial-history chronology, not covered here.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Years represented:** 2024, 2025
- **Paper(s):** GS-II, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	Prelims GS-I	91	Instability and military coups in the Sahel region	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2025	GS-II	9	India-Africa digital partnership	Elaborate · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Instability and military coups in the Sahel region
- India-Africa digital partnership

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule:** The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented:** 2021, 2023
- **Paper(s):** GS-II, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2021	GS-II	9	India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's growth prospects	Examine · 10 marks · 150 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	Prelims GS-I	98	Military coups in Chad Guinea Mali Sudan West Africa	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's growth prospects
- Military coups in Chad Guinea Mali Sudan West Africa

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - THE AFRICAN-OWNED FRAMEWORK AND HONEST QUESTION OWNERSHIP

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - The African-owned framework and honest question ownership

|
v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · The African-owned framework · honest question ownership · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Subject

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Limitation: do not caricature Chinese engagement as uniformly extractive or assume African states passively choose between India and China; compare delivery, finance terms, local ownership and sector fit.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand.

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Agenda 2063 as the African-owned framework the partnership must fit - Honest question ownership for this India-Africa owner Qualified use: Close by testing alignment against Africa's own plan and by stating the ownership boundary explicitly.

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS DEEP-REVIEW CORE CONTROL

- **Must remember:** India-Africa relations combine political solidarity, capacity-building, concessional finance, trade, health, education, digital public infrastructure and maritime security through demand-driven partnership and African institutional agency.
- **Close distinction:** Africa is not a single actor, African Union membership is not the same as state membership in every regional community, a line of credit is not a grant, project approval is not completion, and digital technology transfer is not automatic institutional adoption.
- **Status / evidence / implementation limit:** Name the country, African or regional institution, instrument, financier, implementation stage and outcome evidence; test debt sustainability, procurement, maintenance, data governance, local skills, market access and comparison with alternative partners without paternalism.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies What this India-Africa owner holds and how its boundaries are routed?

A. This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner. B. The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity. C. Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure. D. Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point.

Answer: A. Explanation: This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history

chronology belongs to the World History owner. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q2. Which card should be filed under What this India-Africa owner holds and how its boundaries are routed in an International Relations answer?

A. Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states. B. This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner. C. Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point. D. Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure.

Answer: B. Explanation: This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What this India-Africa owner holds and how its boundaries are routed?

A. Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure. B. Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states. C. This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner. D. Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point.

Answer: C. Explanation: This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What this India-Africa owner holds and how its boundaries are routed?

A. Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure. B. Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and

member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states. C. Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current. D. This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner.

Answer: D. Explanation: This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The India-Africa Forum Summit cycle and its honest gap?

A. The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity. B. Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point. C. Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure. D. Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member

states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states.

Answer: A. Explanation: The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q6. Which card should be filed under The India-Africa Forum Summit cycle and its honest gap in an International Relations answer?

A. Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point. B. The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity. C. Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure. D. Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states.

Answer: B. Explanation: The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The India-Africa Forum Summit cycle and its honest gap?

A. Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current. B. Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states. C. The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity. D. Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure.

Answer: C. Explanation: The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The India-Africa Forum Summit cycle and its honest gap?

A. Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current. B. Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure. C. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure. D. The

India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity.

Answer: D. Explanation: The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies The capacity-building grant announced at the first summit?

A. Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure. B. Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states. C. Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point. D. Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q10. Which card should be filed under The capacity-building grant announced at the first summit in an International Relations answer?

A. Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure. B. Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure. C. Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current. D. Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The capacity-building grant announced at the first summit?

A. Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure. B. Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current. C. Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure

may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure. D. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The capacity-building grant announced at the first summit?

A. The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification. B. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure. C. Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current. D. Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Training positions and the technical-cooperation boundary?

A. Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point. B. Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current. C. Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure. D. Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q14. Which card should be filed under Training positions and the technical-cooperation boundary in an International Relations answer?

A. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure. B. Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point. C. Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure. D. Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the

digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Training positions and the technical-cooperation boundary?

A. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure. B. Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current. C. Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point. D. The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Training positions and the technical-cooperation boundary?

A. The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification. B. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. C. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure. D. Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies The nineteen jointly established institutions?

A. Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states. B. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure. C. Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and

not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure. D. Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q18. Which card should be filed under The nineteen jointly established institutions in an International Relations answer?

A. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure. B. Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states. C. The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification. D. Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission

and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The nineteen jointly established institutions?

A. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure. B. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. C. Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states. D. The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The nineteen jointly established institutions?

A. The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth,

and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification. B. The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question. C. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. D. Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies African student mobility as a human-capital multiplier?

A. Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure. B. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure. C. Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current. D. The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development,

space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q22. Which card should be filed under African student mobility as a human-capital multiplier in an International Relations answer?

A. The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification. B. Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure. C. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure. D. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of African student mobility as a human-capital multiplier?

A. The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question. B. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and

that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. C. Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure. D. The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about African student mobility as a human-capital multiplier?

A. Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence. B. The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question. C. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. D. Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies The Pan African e-Network and its named successor?

A. Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current. B. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. C. The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification. D. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q26. Which card should be filed under The Pan African e-Network and its named successor in an International Relations answer?

A. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. B. Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current. C. The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar

Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification. D. The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Pan African e-Network and its named successor?

A. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. B. Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence. C. Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current. D. The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African

e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Pan African e-Network and its named successor?

A. The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment. B. The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question. C. Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence. D. Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Successor-network coverage and the offered-versus-completed line?

A. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure. B. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. C. The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider

digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question. D. The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q30. Which card should be filed under Successor-network coverage and the offered-versus-completed line in an International Relations answer?

A. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. B. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure. C. Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence. D. The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Successor-network coverage and the offered-versus-completed line?

A. The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment. B. The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question. C. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure. D. Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Successor-network coverage and the offered-versus-completed line?

A. Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence. B. The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment. C. The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice. D. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat

as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies The India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 2 July 2024?

A. The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification. B. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. C. Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence. D. The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question.

Answer: A. Explanation: The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q34. Which card should be filed under The India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 2 July 2024 in an International Relations answer?

A. The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question. B. The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification. C. The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment. D. Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence.

Answer: B. Explanation: The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 2 July 2024?

A. Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence. B. The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation

Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice. C. The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification. D. The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment.

Answer: C. Explanation: The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 2 July 2024?

A. The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment. B. The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation. C. The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice. D. The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati,

renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification.

Answer: D. Explanation: The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Lines of credit as commitments rather than disbursements?

A. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. B. Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence. C. The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment. D. The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q38. Which card should be filed under Lines of credit as commitments rather than disbursements in an International Relations answer?

A. Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence. B. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. C. The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment. D. The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Lines of credit as commitments rather than disbursements?

A. The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment. B. The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice. C. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. D. The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in

March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Lines of credit as commitments rather than disbursements?

A. The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance. B. The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation. C. The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice. D. The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies India-Africa trade and the Economy boundary?

A. The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question. B. Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence. C. The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice. D. The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment.

Answer: A. Explanation: The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q42. Which card should be filed under India-Africa trade and the Economy boundary in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice. B. The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question. C. The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment. D. The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India

in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation.

Answer: B. Explanation: The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of India-Africa trade and the Economy boundary?

A. The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance. B. The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation. C. The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question. D. The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice.

Answer: C. Explanation: The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about India-Africa trade and the Economy boundary?

A. The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims. B. The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation. C. The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance. D. The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question.

Answer: D. Explanation: The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development as the model claim?

A. Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence. B. The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation. C. The owners define digital sovereignty here as the

requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice. D. The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q46. Which card should be filed under Demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development as the model claim in an International Relations answer?

A. The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice. B. Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence. C. The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation. D. The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an

engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development as the model claim?

A. The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims. B. The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation. C. Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence. D. The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development as the model claim?

A. Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive. B. The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance. C. The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims. D. Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies The implementation and maintenance test?

A. The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment. B. The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation. C.

The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice. D. The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q50. Which card should be filed under The implementation and maintenance test in an International Relations answer?

A. The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims. B. The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment. C. The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation. D. The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence

of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The implementation and maintenance test?

A. The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance. B. The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims. C. The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment. D. Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The implementation and maintenance test?

A. The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it. B. The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines,

vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims. C. Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive. D. The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Digital sovereignty as an unresolved design question?

A. The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice. B. The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation. C. The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance. D. The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each

of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q54. Which card should be filed under Digital sovereignty as an unresolved design question in an International Relations answer?

A. Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive. B. The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice. C. The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance. D. The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Digital sovereignty as an unresolved design question?

A. The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it. B. Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive. C. The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice. D. The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Digital sovereignty as an unresolved design question?

A. Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel

instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive. B. The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it. C. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. D. The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies The defence-dialogue and field-exercise limb?

A. The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation. B. The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance. C. The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with

headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims. D. Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive.

Answer: A. Explanation: The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q58. Which card should be filed under The defence-dialogue and field-exercise limb in an International Relations answer?

A. The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims. B. The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation. C. Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive. D. The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the

Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it.

Answer: B. Explanation: The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The defence-dialogue and field-exercise limb?

A. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. B. Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive. C. The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation. D. The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it.

Answer: C. Explanation: The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October

2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The defence-dialogue and field-exercise limb?

A. This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner. B. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. C. The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it. D. The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation.

Answer: D. Explanation: The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape

cooperation. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies The African Union's permanent seat in the Group of Twenty?

A. The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance. B. The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it. C. The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims. D. Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive.

Answer: A. Explanation: The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q62. Which card should be filed under The African Union's permanent seat in the Group of Twenty in an International Relations answer?

A. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official

Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. B. The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance. C. The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it. D. Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive.

Answer: B. Explanation: The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The African Union's permanent seat in the Group of Twenty?

A. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. B. The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it. C. The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because

membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance. D. This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner.

Answer: C. Explanation: The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The African Union's permanent seat in the Group of Twenty?

A. The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity. B. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. C. This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner. D. The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance.

Answer: D. Explanation: The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Health, pharmaceutical and plurilateral extensions?

A. The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims. B. The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it. C. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. D. Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims. The remaining options belong

Q66. Which card should be filed under Health, pharmaceutical and plurilateral extensions in an International Relations answer?

A. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. B. The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims. C. The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it. D. This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Health, pharmaceutical and plurilateral extensions?

A. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. B. The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity. C. The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims. D. This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Health, pharmaceutical and plurilateral extensions?

A. The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity. B. Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure. C. This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner. D. The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Political risk in the Sahel and the comparator question?

A. Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive. B.

This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner. C. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. D. The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it.

Answer: A. Explanation: Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q70. Which card should be filed under Political risk in the Sahel and the comparator question in an International Relations answer?

A. This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner. B. Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and

West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive. C. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. D. The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity.

Answer: B. Explanation: Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Political risk in the Sahel and the comparator question?

A. This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner. B. The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity. C. Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and

military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive. D. Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure.

Answer: C. Explanation: Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Political risk in the Sahel and the comparator question?

A. Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure. B. The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity. C. Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point. D. Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive.

Answer: D. Explanation: Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the

2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Agenda 2063 as the African-owned framework the partnership must fit?

A. The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it. B. This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner. C. The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity. D. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand.

Answer: A. Explanation: The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q74. Which card should be filed under Agenda 2063 as the African-owned framework the partnership must fit in an International Relations answer?

A. Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure. B. The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it. C. The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity. D. This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner.

Answer: B. Explanation: The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Agenda 2063 as the African-owned framework the partnership must fit?

A. Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point. B. The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on

24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity. C. The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it. D. Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure.

Answer: C. Explanation: The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Agenda 2063 as the African-owned framework the partnership must fit?

A. Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point. B. Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states. C. Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure. D. The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the

Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it.

Answer: D. Explanation: The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Honest question ownership for this India-Africa owner?

A. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. B. Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure. C. The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity. D. This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner.

Answer: A. Explanation: The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic;

two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q78. Which card should be filed under Honest question ownership for this India-Africa owner in an International Relations answer?

A. The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity. B. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. C. Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure. D. Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point.

Answer: B. Explanation: The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Honest question ownership for this India-Africa owner?

A. Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states. B. Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure. C. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. D. Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point.

Answer: C. Explanation: The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Honest question ownership for this India-Africa owner?

A. Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure. B. Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an

explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point. C. Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states. D. The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand.

Answer: D. Explanation: The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. The remaining options belong to different actors, instruments, evidentiary levels or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED PYQ OWNERSHIP AUDIT

Two General Studies Paper II Mains demands are routed to this topic in the audited routing ledgers and each is reproduced below as a demand card with its printed year, paper, question number, directive, marks and word limit exactly as the ledger records them: 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words, for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership; and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic. Two objective demands are also routed to this owner and are carried as coverage requirements only: 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally; and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally and its presence is recorded without being used. No option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. The locally held OCR-searchable official General Studies papers were read only to confirm the printed wording of the routed Mains demands; no question was invented from them, no stem was paraphrased into an apparent routing, and no marking scheme or official answer key was imported.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- FACT: **2021 GS-II**: "If the last few decades were of Asia's growth story, the next few are expected to be of Africa's. In the light of this statement, examine India's influence in Africa in recent years." Structure by development partnership, trade/investment, capacity-building, diplomacy and implementation constraints; do not reduce the answer to digital cooperation.

- FACT: **2025 Q9 (direct)**: *India-Africa digital partnership is achieving mutual respect, co-development and long-term institutional partnerships. Elaborate.* Structure: (1) trace the Pan African e-Network (concluded 2017) to its e-VBAB successor (launched 2019); (2) cite the India-SADC MoU (2 July 2024, ICT/ connectivity/access/DPI pillar) as current evidence; (3) evidence "institutional partnership" via the nineteen jointly established institutions; (4) evidence "mutual respect/co-development" via the demand-driven, non-intrusive model and African student mobility; (5) avoid overstating continent-wide DPI rollout as completed.

Recent PYQ Integration (2024-2025)

Status: 2024-2025 question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance**: Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2024-2025.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2024-2025.md. **Answer-key rule**: The official 2024-2025 Prelims Set-A keys are present in the repository and CSAT Set-A keys are supplied; even so, no option or answer is recorded or inferred in this integration.

- **Years represented**: 2024, 2025
- **Paper(s)**: GS-II, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands**: 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2024	Prelims GS-I	91	Instability and military coups in the Sahel region	Objective question; official Set-A key available locally, answer not inferred	Key available locally (official Set-A answer key present); answer not recorded here	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.
2025	GS-II	9	India-Africa digital partnership	Elaborate · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Instability and military coups in the Sahel region
- India-Africa digital partnership

This block integrates the 2024-2025 examinable demand and paper metadata. It is kept separate from the 2018-2023 block and does not convert an unkeyed/answer-free objective question into a solved answer.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance**: Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md, _PYQ-ROUTING-PRELIMS-2018-2023.md. **Answer-key rule**: The official 2018-2023 Prelims/CSAT keys are not held locally; no option or answer has been inferred.

- **Years represented**: 2021, 2023
- **Paper(s)**: GS-II, Prelims GS-I
- **Routed question demands**: 2

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2021	GS-II	9	India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's growth prospects	Examine · 10 marks · 150 words	Core route supersedes older Advanced ownership	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.
2023	Prelims GS-I	98	Military coups in Chad Guinea Mali Sudan West Africa	Objective question; official key unavailable locally	Routed; key unavailable locally	Cover the named fact/concept and its likely statement-level distinctions.

What this owner must now support

- India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's growth prospects
- Military coups in Chad Guinea Mali Sudan West Africa

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- FACT: **2021 GS-II** tests India's wider influence in Africa against the continent's expected growth story. Use a balanced influence matrix (development, trade, capacity, diplomacy) and then test delivery, competition and African agency.

- FACT: **2025 Q9 (direct)**: *India-Africa digital partnership is achieving mutual respect, co-development and long-term institutional partnerships. Elaborate.* An advanced answer should:

1. Separate the three claimed elements (mutual respect, co-development, long-term institutional partnership) and evidence each distinctly.
2. Trace the Pan African e-Network (concluded 2017) to e-VBAB (launched 2019), then cite the SADC MoU (2 July 2024) as a current digital-cooperation instrument.
3. Apply the implementation/maintenance test to qualify "long-term" - noting that sustained functioning, not the initial announcement, is the true measure.
4. Avoid overstating scale (continent-wide claims) beyond what the specific, dated instruments support.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2021
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2021	GS-II	9	India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's growth prospects	Examine · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's growth prospects

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2021 General Studies Paper II Question 9

Demand: "If the last few decades were of Asia's growth story, the next few are expected to be of Africa's." In the light of this statement, examine India's influence in Africa in recent years. An Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger and confirmed against the locally held official paper.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger, where the Core route is recorded as superseding the older Advanced ownership. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: India's influence in Africa is real but instrument-specific, resting on human-capital and institutional investment rather than on financing scale, and it is best measured by what has been sustained rather than by what has been announced. Named evidence and example: the India-Africa Forum Summit framework, held at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015, with a fourth edition announced on 23 April 2026 and postponed on 21 May 2026; the grant of five hundred million United States dollars for human resource development and capacity building announced at the first summit; one thousand six hundred training positions offered to Africa under India's technical cooperation programme, distinct from the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme's global total of more than two lakh trainees from over one hundred and sixty countries recorded by the Economic Survey 2025-26; nineteen institutions being established jointly with the African Union Commission and member states; ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students in India at any time; more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries and India-Africa trade of USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25 per the Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026; the first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 with its Lucknow Declaration, the Gandhinagar dialogue of October 2022 and AFINDEX in 2019 and March 2023; and the African Union's admission as a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023. Analysis: these instruments produce influence through four different mechanisms, since training and joint institutions build in-country capacity that outlives a project cycle, student mobility and telemedicine create durable professional networks, concessional credit buys project presence without matching the scale of larger financiers, and the Group of Twenty outcome shows India converting advocacy into a checkable institutional result; the growth-story framing therefore raises the stakes, because a faster-growing Africa will have more partnership options and will select partners on delivery rather than on solidarity. Qualification: influence claims must be bounded, because extended lines of credit are commitments and not disbursements, nineteen institutions are not coverage across fifty-four states, defence declarations are not operational capability transfer, one seat in one forum is not systemic reform, coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger between 2020 and 2023 show that project risk is regionally specific, and the Forum on China-Africa Cooperation route must be compared on finance terms and local ownership rather than caricatured. Why this earns marks: it evidences influence across development, education, digital, security and representation limbs with dated anchors, then converts the growth-story premise into a delivery test instead of a celebration.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2021 General Studies Paper II Question 9", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: India's influence in Africa is real but instrument-specific, resting on human-capital and institutional investment rather than on financing scale, and it is best measured by what has been sustained rather than by what has been announced. Named evidence and example: the India-Africa Forum Summit framework, held at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015, with a fourth edition announced on 23 April 2026 and postponed on 21 May 2026; the grant of five hundred million United States dollars for human resource development and capacity building announced at the first summit; one thousand six hundred training positions offered to Africa under India's technical cooperation programme, distinct from the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme's global total of more than two lakh trainees from over one hundred and sixty countries recorded by the Economic Survey 2025-26; nineteen institutions being established jointly with the

African Union Commission and member states; ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students in India at any time; more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries and India-Africa trade of USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25 per the Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026; the first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 with its Lucknow Declaration, the Gandhinagar dialogue of October 2022 and AFINDEX in 2019 and March 2023; and the African Union's admission as a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023. Analysis: these instruments produce influence through four different mechanisms, since training and joint institutions build in-country capacity that outlives a project cycle, student mobility and telemedicine create durable professional networks, concessional credit buys project presence without matching the scale of larger financiers, and the Group of Twenty outcome shows India converting advocacy into a checkable institutional result; the growth-story framing therefore raises the stakes, because a faster-growing Africa will have more partnership options and will select partners on delivery rather than on solidarity. Qualification: influence claims must be bounded, because extended lines of credit are commitments and not disbursements, nineteen institutions are not coverage across fifty-four states, defence declarations are not operational capability transfer, one seat in one forum is not systemic reform, coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger between 2020 and 2023 show that project risk is regionally specific, and the Forum on China-Africa Cooperation route must be compared on finance terms and local ownership rather than caricatured. Why this earns marks: it evidences influence across development, education, digital, security and representation limbs with dated anchors, then converts the growth-story premise into a delivery test instead of a celebration.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2021 General Studies Paper II Question 9 **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: India's influence in Africa is real but instrument-specific, resting on human-capital and institutional investment rather than on financing scale, and it is best measured by what has been sustained rather than by what has been announced. Named evidence and example: the India-Africa Forum Summit framework, held at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015, with a fourth edition announced on 23 April 2026 and postponed on 21 May 2026; the grant of five hundred million United States dollars for human resource development and capacity building announced at the first summit; one thousand six hundred training positions offered to Africa under India's technical cooperation programme, distinct from the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme's global total of more than two lakh trainees from over one hundred and sixty countries recorded by the Economic Survey 2025-26; nineteen institutions being established jointly with the African Union Commission and member states; ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students in India at any time; more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries and India-Africa trade of USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25 per the Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026; the first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 with its Lucknow Declaration, the Gandhinagar dialogue of October 2022 and AFINDEX in 2019 and March 2023; and the African Union's admission as a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023. Analysis: these instruments produce influence through four different mechanisms, since training and joint institutions build in-country capacity that outlives a project cycle, student mobility and telemedicine create durable professional networks, concessional credit buys project presence without matching the scale of larger financiers, and the Group of Twenty outcome shows India converting advocacy into a checkable institutional result; the growth-story framing therefore raises the stakes, because a faster-growing Africa will have more partnership options and will select partners on delivery rather than on solidarity. Qualification: influence claims must be bounded, because extended lines of credit are commitments and not disbursements, nineteen institutions are not coverage across fifty-four states, defence declarations are not operational capability transfer, one seat in one forum is not systemic reform, coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger between 2020 and 2023 show that project risk is regionally specific, and the Forum on China-Africa Cooperation route must be compared on finance terms and local ownership rather than caricatured. Why this earns marks: it evidences

influence across development, education, digital, security and representation limbs with dated anchors, then converts the growth-story premise into a delivery test instead of a celebration.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2021 General Studies Paper II Question 9”, replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2025 General Studies Paper II Question 9

Demand: India-Africa digital partnership is achieving mutual respect, co-development and long-term institutional partnerships. Elaborate. An Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words, exactly as recorded in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger and confirmed against the locally held official paper.

Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger and reproduced in the Basic owner as the anchor demand for this topic. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed.

Model solution: Claim: the statement's three elements are separable and each is supported by a different kind of evidence, so an elaboration must evidence mutual respect through design, co-development through governance and long-term partnership through continuity, rather than merging them into a single claim of success. Named evidence and example: mutual respect is evidenced by the demand-driven, non-intrusive model Tharoor describes as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions, and by the India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation of 2 July 2024, whose new and emerging technologies pillar covering information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure is framed against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an Indian template, and which renews an earlier memorandum of 14 October 1997; co-development is evidenced by the nineteen institutions being established jointly with the African Union Commission and member states and by the tele-education and tele-medicine succession from the Pan African e-Network, concluded in 2017, to the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project, whose implementation agreement with Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and which was launched in 2019; long-term institutional partnership is evidenced by that network's recorded reach of twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered in the Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026, and by the standing presence of ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students in India. Analysis: the design evidence matters because framing a cooperation pillar against the partner's own published strategy is what converts a technology offer into a respectful one, the governance evidence matters because a jointly governed institution transfers decision rights rather than only equipment, and the continuity evidence matters because a network that keeps enrolling and treating people is the only proof that partnership language has outlived its launch. Qualification: the elaboration must concede that a memorandum is a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery require separate verification, that scholarships offered is an input measure and not completed training or employment, that no continent-wide rollout of digital public infrastructure is established by these instruments, that digital sovereignty and data-governance questions are framed rather than resolved, and that the summit architecture itself shows a gap, since the third India-Africa Forum Summit of 26-29 October 2015 remains the last one held while the fourth was announced on 23 April 2026 and postponed on 21 May 2026. Why this earns marks: it separates and separately evidences all three words of the statement with dated instruments and then applies an explicit maintenance test instead of asserting achievement.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2025 General Studies Paper II Question 9”, every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Claim: the statement's three elements are separable and each is supported by a different kind of evidence, so an elaboration must evidence mutual respect through design, co-development through

governance and long-term partnership through continuity, rather than merging them into a single claim of success. Named evidence and example: mutual respect is evidenced by the demand-driven, non-intrusive model Tharoor describes as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions, and by the India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation of 2 July 2024, whose new and emerging technologies pillar covering information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure is framed against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an Indian template, and which renews an earlier memorandum of 14 October 1997; co-development is evidenced by the nineteen institutions being established jointly with the African Union Commission and member states and by the tele-education and tele-medicine succession from the Pan African e-Network, concluded in 2017, to the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project, whose implementation agreement with Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and which was launched in 2019; long-term institutional partnership is evidenced by that network's recorded reach of twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered in the Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026, and by the standing presence of ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students in India. Analysis: the design evidence matters because framing a cooperation pillar against the partner's own published strategy is what converts a technology offer into a respectful one, the governance evidence matters because a jointly governed institution transfers decision rights rather than only equipment, and the continuity evidence matters because a network that keeps enrolling and treating people is the only proof that partnership language has outlived its launch. Qualification: the elaboration must concede that a memorandum is a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery require separate verification, that scholarships offered is an input measure and not completed training or employment, that no continent-wide rollout of digital public infrastructure is established by these instruments, that digital sovereignty and data-governance questions are framed rather than resolved, and that the summit architecture itself shows a gap, since the third India-Africa Forum Summit of 26-29 October 2015 remains the last one held while the fourth was announced on 23 April 2026 and postponed on 21 May 2026. Why this earns marks: it separates and separately evidences all three words of the statement with dated instruments and then applies an explicit maintenance test instead of asserting achievement.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2025 General Studies Paper II Question 9 **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Status: Routed to this owner in the audited 2024-2025 Mains routing ledger and reproduced in the Basic owner as the anchor demand for this topic. No official answer key exists for a Mains demand and none is claimed. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Claim: the statement's three elements are separable and each is supported by a different kind of evidence, so an elaboration must evidence mutual respect through design, co-development through governance and long-term partnership through continuity, rather than merging them into a single claim of success. Named evidence and example: mutual respect is evidenced by the demand-driven, non-intrusive model Tharoor describes as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions, and by the India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation of 2 July 2024, whose new and emerging technologies pillar covering information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure is framed against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an Indian template, and which renews an earlier memorandum of 14 October 1997; co-development is evidenced by the nineteen institutions being established jointly with the African Union Commission and member states and by the tele-education and tele-medicine succession from the Pan African

e-Network, concluded in 2017, to the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project, whose implementation agreement with Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and which was launched in 2019; long-term institutional partnership is evidenced by that network's recorded reach of twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered in the Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026, and by the standing presence of ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students in India. Analysis: the design evidence matters because framing a cooperation pillar against the partner's own published strategy is what converts a technology offer into a respectful one, the governance evidence matters because a jointly governed institution transfers decision rights rather than only equipment, and the continuity evidence matters because a network that keeps enrolling and treating people is the only proof that partnership language has outlived its launch. Qualification: the elaboration must concede that a memorandum is a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery require separate verification, that scholarships offered is an input measure and not completed training or employment, that no continent-wide rollout of digital public infrastructure is established by these instruments, that digital sovereignty and data-governance questions are framed rather than resolved, and that the summit architecture itself shows a gap, since the third India-Africa Forum Summit of 26-29 October 2015 remains the last one held while the fourth was announced on 23 April 2026 and postponed on 21 May 2026. Why this earns marks: it separates and separately evidences all three words of the statement with dated instruments and then applies an explicit maintenance test instead of asserting achievement.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

How to improve this answer: For "PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2025 General Studies Paper II Question 9", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Examine India's influence in Africa in the light of the expectation that the coming decades will be Africa's growth story. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Influence must be evidenced through instruments rather than asserted, so the examination must name the summit framework and its honest gap, evidence capacity building and credit commitments at their true evidentiary level, add the one concrete representation outcome, and close on delivery rather than announcement.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity.
- Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states.
- The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number.

- The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance.

Qualified conclusion: Influence must be evidenced through instruments rather than asserted, so the examination must name the summit framework and its honest gap, evidence capacity building and credit commitments at their true evidentiary level, add the one concrete representation outcome, and close on delivery rather than announcement.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine India's influence in Africa in the light of the expectation that the coming decades...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Influence must be evidenced through instruments rather than asserted, so the examination must name the summit framework and its honest gap, evidence capacity building and credit commitments at their true evidentiary level, add the one concrete representation outcome, and close on delivery rather than announcement.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation

outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Influence must be evidenced through instruments rather than asserted, so the examination must name the summit framework and its honest gap, evidence capacity building and credit commitments at their true evidentiary level, add the one concrete representation outcome, and close on delivery rather than announcement.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine India's influence in Africa in the light of the expectation that the coming decades...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Comment on the proposition that India's Africa engagement is a donor-driven aid relationship rather than a co-development partnership. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The proposition fails against the joint-governance structure and the non-intrusive framing, so the comment must cite the jointly established institutions, the demand-driven model wording and the training instruments, and must still concede that the model's credibility rests on African priority-setting rather than on Indian intent alone.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence.
- Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states.
- Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural

diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point.

- The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims.

Qualified conclusion: The proposition fails against the joint-governance structure and the non-intrusive framing, so the comment must cite the jointly established institutions, the demand-driven model wording and the training instruments, and must still concede that the model's credibility rests on African priority-setting rather than on Indian intent alone.

Demand decoding: The directive **comment** requires a direct position on “Comment on the proposition that India's Africa engagement is a donor-driven aid relationship...”, every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The proposition fails against the joint-governance structure and the non-intrusive framing, so the comment must cite the jointly established institutions, the demand-driven model wording and the training instruments, and must still concede that the model's credibility rests on African priority-setting rather than on Indian intent alone.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred

and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The proposition fails against the joint-governance structure and the non-intrusive framing, so the comment must cite the jointly established institutions, the demand-driven model wording and the training instruments, and must still concede that the model's credibility rests on African priority-setting rather than on Indian intent alone.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Comment on the proposition that India's Africa engagement is a donor-driven aid relationship...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Elaborate on how the India-Africa digital partnership is achieving mutual respect, co-development and long-term institutional partnership. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: The three claimed elements must be separated and evidenced distinctly, so the elaboration must trace the network succession, cite the dated memorandum pillar for current digital cooperation, evidence institutional partnership through joint governance, and apply the maintenance test to the word long-term.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners

are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current.

- The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure.
- The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification.
- The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment.

Qualified conclusion: The three claimed elements must be separated and evidenced distinctly, so the elaboration must trace the network succession, cite the dated memorandum pillar for current digital cooperation, evidence institutional partnership through joint governance, and apply the maintenance test to the word long-term.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Elaborate on how the India-Africa digital partnership is achieving mutual respect, co-...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The three claimed elements must be separated and evidenced distinctly, so the elaboration must trace the network succession, cite the dated memorandum pillar for current digital cooperation, evidence institutional partnership through joint governance, and apply the maintenance test to the word long-term.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of

delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The three claimed elements must be separated and evidenced distinctly, so the elaboration must trace the network succession, cite the dated memorandum pillar for current digital cooperation, evidence institutional partnership through joint governance, and apply the maintenance test to the word long-term.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "Elaborate on how the India-Africa digital partnership is achieving mutual respect, co-...", replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine why announced development-partnership figures overstate what India has actually delivered in Africa. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Overstatement is structural rather than accidental, so the examination must separate commitment from disbursement, announcement from functioning institution and offered scholarships from completed training, and must show that each gap has its own verification requirement.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure.
- The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number.
- The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment.
- The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure.

Qualified conclusion: Overstatement is structural rather than accidental, so the examination must separate commitment from disbursement, announcement from functioning institution and offered scholarships from completed training, and must show that each gap has its own verification requirement.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine why announced development-partnership figures overstate what India has actually...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Overstatement is structural rather than accidental, so the examination must separate commitment from disbursement, announcement from functioning institution and offered scholarships from completed training, and must show that each gap has its own verification requirement.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official

source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Overstatement is structural rather than accidental, so the examination must separate commitment from disbursement, announcement from functioning institution and offered scholarships from completed training, and must show that each gap has its own verification requirement.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Examine why announced development-partnership figures overstate what India has actually...”, replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess India's Africa partnership model against the alternative external partnership routes available to African states. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Comparison must be evidence-based rather than moralised, so the assessment must state India's specific comparative strengths, price political risk honestly, refuse to caricature the competing route, and close with a graded verdict that rests on delivery and local ownership.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive.
- Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence.
- Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point.
- The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question.

Qualified conclusion: Comparison must be evidence-based rather than moralised, so the assessment must state India's specific comparative strengths, price political risk honestly, refuse to caricature the competing route, and close with a graded verdict that rests on delivery and local ownership.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess India's Africa partnership model against the alternative external partnership routes...", every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Comparison must be evidence-based rather than moralised, so the assessment must state India's specific comparative strengths, price political risk honestly, refuse to caricature the competing route, and close with a graded verdict that rests on delivery and local ownership.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the

audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

2. **Claim and named evidence:** Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Comparison must be evidence-based rather than moralised, so the assessment must state India's specific comparative strengths, price political risk honestly, refuse to caricature the competing route, and close with a graded verdict that rests on delivery and local ownership.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Assess India's Africa partnership model against the alternative external partnership routes...”, replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess whether India's Africa partnership is genuinely aligned with African-owned development priorities. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Alignment is testable rather than declarative, so the assessment must set the partnership against the African-owned continental framework, test it through the maintenance and digital-sovereignty questions, credit the one delivered representation outcome, and refuse to predict any future summit or project result.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it.
- The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice.
- The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance.
- The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand.

Qualified conclusion: Alignment is testable rather than declarative, so the assessment must set the partnership against the African-owned continental framework, test it through the maintenance and digital-sovereignty questions, credit the one delivered representation outcome, and refuse to predict any future summit or project result.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess whether India's Africa partnership is genuinely aligned with African-owned development...”, every clause, bilateral/regional/systemic mapping, interests

and constraints, objective-instrument-implementation-outcome separation, named Indian evidence, trade-offs, alternatives, implementation risks and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Alignment is testable rather than declarative, so the assessment must set the partnership against the African-owned continental framework, test it through the maintenance and digital-sovereignty questions, credit the one delivered representation outcome, and refuse to predict any future summit or project result.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests -> chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand. **Analysis:** Connect Indian and partner interests ->

chosen diplomatic, security, economic or institutional instrument -> implementation mechanism -> bilateral, regional and systemic consequence. **Qualification:** State membership and mandate, announced/signed/ratified/operative/completed status, official source and date, partner agency, causal limit, trade-off, alternative or residual implementation risk.

Counter-position / limit: A doctrine label, summit declaration, signed document, project announcement, military exercise, trade change or diplomatic statement cannot alone establish binding obligation, operational delivery or strategic outcome; test legal character, implementation, partner response, alternatives and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Alignment is testable rather than declarative, so the assessment must set the partnership against the African-owned continental framework, test it through the maintenance and digital-sovereignty questions, credit the one delivered representation outcome, and refuse to predict any future summit or project result.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing level -> interest -> instrument -> implementation -> outcome -> alternative; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for source, date, membership, operative status, partner agency, causation, escalation and residual risk.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains strategy and implementation rather than listing visits or groupings, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves institutional, status, level, causal and geopolitical distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Assess whether India's Africa partnership is genuinely aligned with African-owned development...”, replace the weakest event-list point with one named actor, interest, instrument, implementation bottleneck, measurable outcome, alternative and source-date-status qualification.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: International Relations | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** GS-II. **Core area:** Demand-driven partnership; co-development; digital sovereignty; implementation/maintenance and African agency. **Grounded in:** Shashi Tharoor, *Pax Indica*; MEA India-SADC economic- cooperation MoU; Economic Survey 2025-26 (ITEC context); 00_Master-Framework.md Sections 4-7. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = inference/analysis | **CURRENT:** = current anchor. *Companion:* basic/07_India-Africa-Development-and-Digital-Partnership.md.

1. Architecture

CAPACITY-BUILDING CORE

\$500 million HRD grant + 1600 technical-cooperation positions + 19 joint institutions

|

v

HUMAN-CAPITAL MULTIPLIER

10,000-15,000 African students in India + tele-education/tele-medicine

|

v

DIGITAL-PARTNERSHIP LAYER

Pan African e-Network (concluded 2017) -> e-VBAB successor + India-SADC MoU (2024, ICT/DPI) -> digital-sovereignty question for African partners

|

v

DEMAND-DRIVEN / NON-INTRUSIVE MODEL

FACT: "non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions" (Tharoor)

|

v

IMPLEMENTATION AND MAINTENANCE TEST

does the institution/network keep functioning after the launch ceremony?

|

v

AFRICAN AGENCY

partner states set priorities; India supplies capacity, not a fixed template

Analytical claim: ANALYSIS: The distinguishing feature of India's Africa partnership - relative to other external development partners - is its explicit demand-driven, capacity-building and non-intrusive framing; the analytical test that separates rhetoric from substance is not the scale of any single announcement but whether jointly built institutions and digital networks are sustained and locally owned after the initial launch.

2. Concepts and distinctions

Concept	Precise meaning
FACT: Human resource development vs. infrastructure aid	FACT: Tharoor: "such endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa" - explicitly distinguishing India's HRD-centred model from a purely physical-infrastructure aid model (though infrastructure cooperation also exists).
ANALYSIS: Digital sovereignty	The concern that DPI/digital-partnership projects should strengthen, not substitute for, an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data. FACT: The India-SADC MoU (2 July 2024) frames its "new and emerging technologies" pillar explicitly against SADC's own RISDP 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy - i.e., against the partner's own stated plan rather than an externally supplied template. ANALYSIS: Framing an instrument around the partner's strategy is evidence of demand-driven design, not proof that data governance and control questions have been resolved in practice.
FACT: Co-development vs. one-way aid transfer	FACT: The nineteen jointly established institutions are explicitly built "jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states" - a structurally different model from a purely India-funded, India-designed facility.
ANALYSIS: Implementation/maintenance test	Whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used, after the initial launch - the genuine test of "long-term institutional partnership" claimed in the 2025 PYQ framing, distinct from the announcement itself.
FACT: Non-intrusive political support	FACT: Tharoor frames India's support to African "democratic institutions" as explicitly "non-intrusive," in contrast to more conditional or prescriptive external-partner models - a genuine point of comparative distinction, though not itself provable as uniformly successful without country-specific, dated evidence.

3. Detailed causal chain: from capacity investment to institutional partnership

- Capacity-building announcement:** FACT: the \$500 million HRD/capacity-building grant at the first IAFS establishes the initial financial commitment.
- Instrument diversification:** FACT: 1600 technical-cooperation training positions and nineteen jointly established institutions translate the financial commitment into concrete, durable capacity - spanning IT, foreign trade, educational planning, diamond processing, vocational training and human settlements.
- Human-capital multiplier through student mobility:** FACT: 10,000-15,000 African students studying in India at any time extends the capacity-building effect beyond the joint institutions into India's own higher-education system.
- Digital layer extends reach without matching physical presence:** FACT: the Pan African e-Network established the tele-education model before concluding in 2017; e-VBAB (MEA-TCIL implementation agreement 10 September 2018; launched 2019) succeeded it with tele-education and tele-medicine services, CURRENT: covering 22 African countries with 15,116 scholarships offered per MEA's April 2026 brief - directly answering the "digital partnership" half of the 2025 PYQ framing. ANALYSIS: Scholarships *offered* is an input measure, not completion or employment outcome.
- MoU-based digital-partnership expansion:** CURRENT: the India-SADC Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation (signed 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat, renewing an earlier MoU of 14 October 1997) extends this digital layer through a "new and emerging technologies" pillar covering ICT development, connectivity, access and Digital Public Infrastructure - framed against SADC's own RISDP 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy, which is itself evidence of the demand-driven design claim.

6. Demand-driven, non-intrusive framing distinguishes the model: FACT:

Tharoor's explicit "non-intrusive" characterisation is the textual anchor for the "mutual respect" and "co-development" language in the 2025 PYQ.

7. **The implementation/maintenance test determines whether "long-term institutional partnership" is genuine:** an advanced answer should note that the true measure of partnership depth is sustained functioning of jointly built institutions and networks, not the scale of the initial announcement.

4. Institutional and reform architecture

- FACT: **Nineteen joint institutions:** the core institutional architecture, spanning IT, foreign trade, educational planning and administration, diamond processing, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes - jointly governed with the African Union Commission and member states.

- FACT: **Pan African e-Network:** historical tele-education-centred precursor addressing the "digital divide"; MEA records it as concluded in 2017.

- FACT: **e-VBAB:** successor tele-education and tele-medicine network (MEA-TCIL implementation agreement 10 September 2018; launched 2019), covering 22 African countries with 15,116 scholarships offered (MEA, April 2026).

- CURRENT: **India-SADC Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation (2 July 2024):** the current dated instrument extending cooperation to a specific African regional economic community across ten areas - industrialisation; human and social development; new and emerging technologies (ICT, connectivity, access, DPI); trade and investment; disaster risk management; women-led development; private sector development; space cooperation; green growth; and research and innovation. It renews an India-SADC MoU of 14 October 1997. ANALYSIS: Entry into force and delivery require separate verification.

- CURRENT: **Quantitative backdrop (MEA Africa brief, April 2026):** more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries; India-Africa trade of USD 81.99 billion in FY2024-25. ANALYSIS: "Extended" LoCs are commitments, not disbursements - the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic.

- ANALYSIS: **ITEC (Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme):** per the Economic Survey 2025-26, a broader technical-cooperation architecture (2-lakh trainees, 160+ countries) within which the Africa-specific 1600 training positions sit - treat ITEC's overall figure as global context, not an Africa-specific data point.

- ANALYSIS: **India-Africa Forum Summit (IAFS):** the umbrella political mechanism - IAFS-I (New Delhi, 8-9 April 2008), IAFS-II (Addis Ababa, 24-25 May 2011), IAFS-III (New Delhi, 26-29 October 2015). CURRENT: IAFS-IV was announced on 23 April 2026 and, on 21 May 2026, India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation. ANALYSIS: A decade-plus gap in the summit cycle is a genuine analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity.

5. Indian applications and boundary cases

- FACT: **Direct PYQ boundary case (2025 Q9):** the question's own framing - "mutual respect, co-development and long-term institutional partnerships" - requires an advanced answer to distinguish these three elements explicitly: mutual respect (non-intrusive, demand-driven design), co-development (joint institution governance), and long-term institutional partnership (implementation/maintenance test), rather than treating them as a single undifferentiated claim.

- ANALYSIS: **Boundary case - digital-partnership scale claims:** an advanced answer should avoid asserting a continent-wide, uniformly delivered DPI rollout; cite the Pan African e-Network as a historical precursor, e-VBAB as its successor and the SADC MoU 2024 as a current instrument.

- ANALYSIS: **Boundary case - ITEC's dual role:** ITEC serves both a general technical-cooperation/cultural-diplomacy function (Economic Survey 2025-26, with an explicit South Asian emphasis) and an Africa-specific training-position role (Tharoor's 1600-position figure) - an advanced answer should not conflate the two

data points.

- ANALYSIS: **Boundary case - African agency in setting priorities:** the model's

credibility depends on demand-driven design (African partners identifying their own capacity needs) rather than a fixed Indian template being applied uniformly - a genuine implementation variable, not a settled achievement.

6. Limitations and trade-offs

- ANALYSIS: **Announcement-to-delivery gap:** grant announcements (\$500 million) and

MoU signings (SADC, 2 July 2024) establish commitments whose actual disbursement and implementation status require separate, dated verification - do not assume full delivery from the announcement alone.

- ANALYSIS: **Maintenance and sustainability risk:** jointly built institutions and digital networks require ongoing staffing, funding and technical support after the initial launch; sustainability is a genuine, not automatic, outcome.

- ANALYSIS: **Scale versus continent-wide claims:** nineteen institutions and 1600

training positions, while substantive, do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all 54 African states - scale claims should be precise, not inflated.

- ANALYSIS: **Digital-sovereignty tension:** DPI-linked cooperation must balance providing technical capacity against ensuring the partner state retains control over its own digital infrastructure and data - an analytical consideration for any specific programme design, not separately documented in the sources reviewed here.

- ANALYSIS: **Non-intrusive framing vs. verifiable outcome:** the "non-intrusive"

characterisation of India's political-support model is a stated intention (Tharoor); whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner state requires country-specific, dated evidence rather than a blanket assumption.

7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims

- FACT: India's \$500 million HRD/capacity-building grant was announced at the first India-Africa Forum Summit.

- FACT: The nineteen jointly established institutions include an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes.

- FACT: ITEC has trained more than two lakh persons from over 160 countries (Economic Survey 2025-26), with an explicit South Asian regional emphasis - distinct from the Africa-specific 1600-position figure.

- CURRENT: The India-SADC Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 and includes ICT development, connectivity, access and Digital Public Infrastructure within its "new and emerging technologies" pillar; it renews an earlier MoU of 14 October 1997.

- CURRENT: MEA's April 2026 Africa brief records 190+ Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion across 41 African countries, India-Africa trade of USD 81.99 billion in FY2024-25, and e-VBAB coverage of 22 countries with 15,116 scholarships offered.

- CURRENT: IAFS-I (2008), IAFS-II (2011) and IAFS-III (2015) were held; IAFS-IV was announced on 23 April 2026 and postponed on 21 May 2026.

8. Advanced Prelims traps

- WRONG: The Pan African e-Network remains the ongoing flagship platform. -> It concluded in 2017; e-VBAB, launched in 2019, is the successor tele-education and tele-medicine network. Neither establishes completed continent-wide DPI coverage.

- WRONG: The ITEC 2-lakh-trainee figure is Africa-specific. -> It is a global figure

across 160+ countries with an explicit South Asian regional emphasis (Economic Survey 2025-26); the Africa-specific figure is the separately cited 1600 training positions.

- **WRONG:** "Non-intrusive" support means India has no political engagement with African democratic processes. -> It means India's engagement model avoids conditionality/prescriptiveness, not that no engagement occurs.

- **WRONG:** Joint institution announcements are equivalent to completed, staffed, functioning institutions. -> Implementation and maintenance require separate, ongoing verification beyond the initial announcement.

9. CURRENT: Current-anchor note

- **CURRENT:** The India-SADC MoU on Economic Cooperation (2 July 2024) remains the most recent verified dated instrument for this topic's digital-partnership dimension, and MEA's April 2026 Africa brief supplies the dated quantitative backdrop. **ANALYSIS:** Two honest qualifications belong in any advanced answer: IAFS-IV was announced (23 April 2026) and postponed (21 May 2026), and the LoC and scholarship figures measure commitments and offers rather than delivery.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- **FACT: 2021 GS-II** tests India's wider influence in Africa against the continent's expected growth story. Use a balanced influence matrix (development, trade, capacity, diplomacy) and then test delivery, competition and African agency.

- **FACT: 2025 Q9 (direct):** *India-Africa digital partnership is achieving mutual respect, co-development and long-term institutional partnerships. Elaborate.* An advanced answer should:

1. Separate the three claimed elements (mutual respect, co-development, long-term institutional partnership) and evidence each distinctly.
2. Trace the Pan African e-Network (concluded 2017) to e-VBAB (launched 2019), then cite the SADC MoU (2 July 2024) as a current digital-cooperation instrument.
3. Apply the implementation/maintenance test to qualify "long-term" - noting that sustained functioning, not the initial announcement, is the true measure.
4. Avoid overstating scale (continent-wide claims) beyond what the specific, dated instruments support.

11. Mains-ready framework

Central thesis: India's Africa partnership is distinguished by its demand-driven, non-intrusive, capacity-building design - evidenced by jointly governed institutions, technical-cooperation training positions and a digital-connectivity layer extended through dated instruments like the SADC MoU (2024) - but its claim to genuine "long-term institutional partnership" must be tested against implementation and maintenance, not merely the scale of announcements.

1. **State the capacity-building core** (grant, training positions, joint institutions) with precise figures.
2. **Distinguish the three PYQ elements** (mutual respect, co-development, institutional partnership) explicitly.
3. **Cite the digital-partnership evidence base** (historical Pan African e-Network, e-VBAB successor, SADC MoU 2024) precisely, without continent-wide overstatement.
4. **Apply the implementation/maintenance test** as the genuine measure of "long-term" partnership.
5. **Acknowledge the digital-sovereignty and sustainability limitations** honestly.
6. **Distinguish ITEC's global role from Africa-specific instruments.**

7. **Close by relating the model back to co-development/African agency** as the defining comparative feature.

12. Probable questions

- **FACT: Mains (10 marks, direct 2025 PYQ):** India-Africa digital partnership is achieving mutual respect, co-development and long-term institutional partnerships. Elaborate.
- **ANALYSIS: Mains (15 marks):** Distinguish India's demand-driven, non-intrusive partnership model from a conditional aid-based model, with reference to Africa.
- **ANALYSIS: Mains (10 marks):** What is the "implementation/maintenance test," and why is it more relevant than announcement scale in evaluating India-Africa institutional partnerships?

13. Study links

- **FACT:** Foundation companion: basic/07_India-Africa-Development-and-Digital-Partnership.md.
- **FACT:** Economy/basic/24_Services-Digital-Economy-Fintech-and-Platform-Markets.md
- **DPI:** digital-economy mechanics.
- **FACT:** 00_Master-Framework.md Section 7 - the announcement-delivery gap applied to Africa partnership claims.
- **ANALYSIS: Cross-links within this folder:** topic 08 (advanced) for Global South representation and coalition-formation theory; topic 09 for ITEC's soft-power role in diaspora/cultural diplomacy.

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2021
- **Paper(s):** GS-II
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2021	GS-II	9	India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's growth prospects	Examine · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's growth prospects

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

India-Africa Development and Digital Partnership: RAPID ACTOR, INSTRUMENT AND DATED-ANCHOR MAP

1. **What this India-Africa owner holds and how its boundaries are routed:** This topic owns India's development partnership with Africa: the India-Africa Forum Summit political framework, the capacity-building and human-resource-development instruments, joint institution building with the African Union Commission and member states, African student mobility, the tele-education and tele-medicine digital layer running from the Pan African e-Network to its e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati successor, lines of credit carried as commitments, and the demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development claim; its distinctive feature is that the partnership is judged on human capital and institutions rather than on infrastructure volume, and two General Studies Paper II

Mains demands from 2021 and 2025 plus two objective demands from 2023 and 2024 are routed here, while bilateral trade-volume and digital-economy mechanics belong to the Economy owner, Global South representation framing belongs to topic 08, diaspora and cultural-diplomacy instruments belong to topic 09, and African colonial-history chronology belongs to the World History owner.

2. **The India-Africa Forum Summit cycle and its honest gap:** The India-Africa Forum Summit is the umbrella political mechanism convening India, African states and the African Union, and the owners record its held editions exactly: the first at New Delhi on 8-9 April 2008, the second at Addis Ababa on 24-25 May 2011 and the third at New Delhi on 26-29 October 2015; a fourth edition was announced on 23 April 2026 for New Delhi and on 21 May 2026 India and the African Union agreed to convene it later owing to the health situation, so it is an announced and postponed summit rather than a held one, and the decade-plus gap after the third edition is itself a legitimate analytical point about the difference between programme continuity and political-architecture continuity.
3. **The capacity-building grant announced at the first summit:** Tharoor records that at the first India-Africa Forum Summit India announced a grant of five hundred million United States dollars specifically to undertake projects in human resource development and capacity building, and the owners treat this as the founding financial commitment of the partnership's human-capital model rather than as an infrastructure package; the boundary is attached in the same place, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement and project completion require separate dated verification, so the figure may open an answer but may never be presented as delivered expenditure.
4. **Training positions and the technical-cooperation boundary:** Tharoor cites one thousand six hundred training positions offered under India's technical cooperation programme to Africa specifically, while the Economic Survey 2025-26 records that the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation Programme has trained more than two lakh persons from over one hundred and sixty countries in both the civilian and the defence sector and describes it as an important tool in strengthening India's cultural diplomacy and influence, especially in the South Asian region; the owners require the two figures to be kept apart, because the two-lakh figure is a global programme total with an explicit South Asian emphasis and is not an Africa-specific data point.
5. **The nineteen jointly established institutions:** Tharoor documents India in the process of establishing nineteen institutions on African soil jointly with the African Union Commission and the member states, including an India-Africa Institute of Information Technology, an India-Africa Institute of Foreign Trade, an India-Africa Institute of Educational Planning and Administration, an India-Africa Diamond Institute, ten vocational training centres and five human settlement institutes; the owners treat joint governance with the African Union Commission and member states as the structural feature that separates co-development from an India-funded and India-designed facility, and they add that nineteen institutions do not amount to continent-wide coverage across all fifty-four African states.
6. **African student mobility as a human-capital multiplier:** Tharoor notes that at any time there are at least ten thousand to fifteen thousand African students studying in various parts of India, which the owners treat as a standing education-diplomacy channel that extends the capacity-building effect beyond the jointly built institutions into India's own higher-education system; the qualification is that a standing range is a book-period stock estimate and not an enrolment record for any specific year, so it evidences a continuing channel rather than a dated annual figure.
7. **The Pan African e-Network and its named successor:** Tharoor describes the Pan African e-Network as seeking to bridge the digital divide through tele-education and information and communication technology connectivity, and the Ministry of External Affairs records that project as concluded in 2017, after which the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project became its tele-education and tele-medicine successor, its implementation agreement between the Ministry and Telecommunications Consultants India Limited was signed on 10 September 2018 and the project was launched in 2019; the owners are categorical that the Pan African e-Network is a historical precursor and not an ongoing flagship platform, so an answer must name the succession instead of treating the older network as current.
8. **Successor-network coverage and the offered-versus-completed line:** The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati participation by twenty-two African countries and 15,116 scholarships offered, which the owners treat as the dated evidence for the digital half of the 2025 demand; the boundary is stated in the same place, because scholarships offered is an input measure and is not the same as students who completed training or obtained employment, so the figure evidences reach rather than outcome

and cannot support a claim of delivered continent-wide digital public infrastructure.

9. **The India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 2 July 2024:** The India-Southern African Development Community Memorandum of Understanding on Economic Cooperation was signed on 2 July 2024 at the SADC Secretariat by SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati, renewing an earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997; it frames cooperation against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy and covers industrialisation, human and social development, new and emerging technologies including information and communication technology development, connectivity, access and digital public infrastructure, trade and investment, disaster risk management, women-led development, private sector development, space cooperation, green growth, and research and innovation; the owners require it to be described as a statement of intent whose entry into force and delivery need separate verification.
10. **Lines of credit as commitments rather than disbursements:** The Ministry of External Affairs Africa brief of April 2026 records more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries, and the owners identify the treatment of extended credit as disbursed money as the single most common overstatement in answers on this topic; the disciplined formulation is that a line of credit extended is a commitment, that disbursement and project completion are separate questions, and that an answer earns marks by naming that distinction rather than by quoting the larger number.
11. **India-Africa trade and the Economy boundary:** The same Ministry of External Affairs brief of April 2026 records India-Africa trade at USD 81.99 billion in the financial year 2024-25, which the owners admit as dated scale evidence while routing bilateral trade-volume mechanics, tariff structure and wider digital-economy detail to the Economy owner; the analytical point retained here is that this topic's syllabus emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership rather than trade volume, so an answer that converts the demand into a trade-and-investment essay has answered a different question.
12. **Demand-driven and non-intrusive co-development as the model claim:** Tharoor frames India's political-cooperation dimension as non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions and records that endeavours to invest in human capital and sustainable political systems have made human resource development a vital aspect of India's model of cooperation with Africa, which the owners treat as the textual anchor for the mutual-respect and co-development language of the 2025 demand; the qualification is that non-intrusive describes an engagement model avoiding conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than an absence of political engagement, and that whether it is uniformly realised across every African partner requires country-specific dated evidence.
13. **The implementation and maintenance test:** The owners define the implementation and maintenance test as the question whether a jointly built institution, training network or digital platform continues functioning, staffed and used after the initial launch ceremony, and they make it the genuine measure of the long-term institutional partnership claimed in the 2025 demand; the consequence for answer writing is that announcement scale is not evidence of partnership depth, so the strongest answers evidence continuity and local ownership instead of repeating the size of the original commitment.
14. **Digital sovereignty as an unresolved design question:** The owners define digital sovereignty here as the requirement that digital-public-infrastructure and connectivity cooperation should strengthen rather than substitute for an African partner's own control over its digital infrastructure and data, and they note that the India-SADC memorandum frames its new and emerging technologies pillar against SADC's own Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and Digital Transformation Strategy rather than an externally supplied template; the boundary is explicit, because framing an instrument around the partner's own plan is evidence of demand-driven design and is not proof that data-governance and control questions have been resolved in practice.
15. **The defence-dialogue and field-exercise limb:** The first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave at Lucknow in February 2020 adopted the Lucknow Declaration and the second India-Africa Defence Dialogue at Gandhinagar in October 2022 adopted a declaration on defence and security cooperation, while the Africa-India Field Training Exercise known as AFINDEX was held in India in 2019 and again in March 2023 as a named peacekeeping and humanitarian mine-action cooperation route, alongside Indian anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation in the western Indian Ocean and the Gulf of Aden; the owners attach the limits directly, namely that declarations and offers are not proof of operational capability transfer, that episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance, and

that African maritime priorities vary so local ownership must shape cooperation.

16. **The African Union's permanent seat in the Group of Twenty:** The African Union became a permanent member of the Group of Twenty at the New Delhi Summit on 9 September 2023, which the owners treat as the single most concrete representation outcome achieved in this cycle and as proof that partnership language can be converted into an institutional result; the qualification is equally firm, because membership of one forum does not resolve Africa's financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits, so the outcome must be described at its real scale rather than presented as systemic reform of global governance.
17. **Health, pharmaceutical and plurilateral extensions:** The Pan African e-Network linked Indian institutions with African partners for tele-education and telemedicine and its successor carries e-ArogyaBharati telemedicine, while affordable Indian generic medicines, vaccines and health training widen access and commercial links; India also launched the New Delhi-headquartered Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure at the United Nations Climate Action Summit on 23 September 2019, and the treaty-based International Solar Alliance Framework Agreement entered into force on 6 December 2017 with headquarters at Gurugram in India; the owners require each of these to be cited as a platform African members can use, with the explicit limits that membership and a global mission are not evidence that any particular African project has been delivered, that digital access and local health capacity determine telemedicine use, and that regulation, local manufacturing, procurement and supply continuity qualify celebratory pharmaceutical claims.
18. **Political risk in the Sahel and the comparator question:** Coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger during 2020 to 2023 illustrate that political and security volatility can delay projects, raise commercial risk and complicate partner selection, and the audited ledgers route two objective demands on this theme to this owner, namely the 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa and the 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region; the owners add that China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and its infrastructure finance give African states another large-scale partnership route, that India's comparative strengths lie in training, affordable technology, digital public infrastructure and demand-driven projects, and that neither Sahel instability nor Chinese engagement may be generalised across the continent or caricatured as uniformly extractive.
19. **Agenda 2063 as the African-owned framework the partnership must fit:** The African Union's own Agenda 2063 overview page, checked live on 2026-09-03, describes Agenda 2063 as Africa's blueprint and master plan for transforming Africa into the global powerhouse of the future, records that African heads of state and government signed the 50th Anniversary Solemn Declaration during the Golden Jubilee celebrations of the formation of the Organisation of African Unity and the African Union in May 2013, states the Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena, sets a fifty-year horizon from 2013 to 2063, and organises delivery through aspirations, flagship programmes and ten-year implementation plans; the owners use this only as the African-owned framework against which a demand-driven partnership claim is tested, and no India-specific project, figure or outcome is taken from it.
20. **Honest question ownership for this India-Africa owner:** The audited ledgers route two General Studies Paper II Mains demands to this owner, namely 2021 General Studies Paper II question 9 on India's influence in Africa in the light of Africa's expected growth story, an Examine demand of 10 marks and 150 words for which the ledger records that the Core route supersedes the older Advanced ownership, and 2025 General Studies Paper II question 9 on the India-Africa digital partnership, an Elaborate demand of 10 marks and 150 words routed to the owning topic; two objective demands are also routed here and carried as coverage requirements only, namely 2023 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 98 on military coups in Chad, Guinea, Mali, Sudan and West Africa, for which the official 2018-2023 Prelims keys are not held locally, and 2024 Prelims General Studies Paper I question 91 on instability and military coups in the Sahel region, for which the official Set-A key is present locally, and no option or answer letter is recorded or inferred for either objective demand.

India-Africa Development and Digital Partnership: CLOSE-OPTION AND STATUS-UPGRADE TRAPS

- Do not describe the India-Africa Forum Summit cycle as continuous, because the third edition of 26-29 October 2015 is the last one held and the fourth was announced on 23 April 2026 and postponed on 21 May 2026.
- Do not treat the announced grant of five hundred million United States dollars as delivered expenditure, because an announced grant is a commitment whose disbursement requires separate dated verification.
- Do not quote the Indian Technical and Economic Cooperation figure of more than two lakh trainees from over one hundred and sixty countries as an Africa-specific number, because it is a global total with an explicit South Asian emphasis while the Africa-specific figure is one thousand six hundred training positions.
- Do not describe the Pan African e-Network as India's ongoing flagship Africa digital platform, because the Ministry of External Affairs records it as concluded in 2017 and the e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project launched in 2019 is its successor.
- Do not read 15,116 scholarships offered in twenty-two African countries as completed training or employment, because scholarships offered is an input measure and not an outcome measure.
- Do not present continent-wide digital public infrastructure as delivered, because the dated instruments support a tele-education and tele-medicine network and a memorandum pillar, not uniform rollout across all fifty-four African states.
- Do not treat the India-SADC Memorandum of Understanding of 2 July 2024 as a delivered outcome, because a memorandum states intent and its entry into force and implementation require separate verification.
- Do not present more than 190 Lines of Credit worth over USD 10 billion extended to 41 African countries as money disbursed, because extended credit measures commitment while disbursement and project completion are separate questions.
- Do not convert this topic into a trade-and-investment essay on the strength of the USD 81.99 billion trade figure for the financial year 2024-25, because trade-volume mechanics belong to the Economy owner and this topic's emphasis is capacity building, education, digital connectivity and institutional partnership.
- Do not read non-intrusive support as an absence of political engagement, because it describes an engagement model that avoids conditionality and prescriptiveness rather than a withdrawal from political cooperation.
- Do not treat the announcement of a joint institution as a staffed and functioning institution, because the implementation and maintenance test asks whether it keeps working after the launch ceremony.
- Do not claim that framing a pillar against a partner's own plan settles digital sovereignty, because framing an instrument around the Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan 2020-2030 and the Digital Transformation Strategy is evidence of demand-driven design and not proof that data-governance and control questions are resolved.
- Do not upgrade the Lucknow Declaration of February 2020, the Gandhinagar declaration of October 2022 or the AFINDEX exercises of 2019 and March 2023 into a defence alliance or into proof of operational capability transfer.
- Do not describe the African Union's permanent Group of Twenty membership of 9 September 2023 as systemic reform of global governance, because it is one forum's membership and does not resolve financing, implementation or United Nations representation deficits.
- Do not use membership of the Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure or the International Solar Alliance as evidence that a particular African project has been delivered, because membership and a global mission are not delivery records.
- Do not generalise Sahel instability to the whole continent or caricature the Forum on China-Africa Cooperation as uniformly extractive, because both moves replace region-specific evidence and African agency with a stereotype.
- Do not treat the African Union's Agenda 2063 material as evidence of any India-Africa project, figure or outcome, because it is an African-owned framework page and supplies only the framework against which a partnership claim is tested.
- Do not invent an aid, grant, credit or disbursement figure, a project or institution status, a digital-partnership deployment or coverage claim, a summit outcome, a memorandum or declaration wording, a trade figure, a defence development, a date, a previous-year question, an answer key or a current claim for this topic.

India-Africa Development and Digital Partnership: ANSWER-WRITING SPINE

NAME INDIA'S PRECISE INTEREST -> IDENTIFY THE EXTERNAL ACTOR AND ITS OWN INCENTIVE
-> CHOOSE THE LEVEL: BILATERAL, REGIONAL, MINILATERAL, MULTILATERAL OR DIASPORA
-> CITE ONE DATED INSTRUMENT AND STATE ITS EXACT EVIDENTIARY LEVEL
-> SEPARATE ANNOUNCED FROM SIGNED, SIGNED FROM IN FORCE, IN FORCE FROM DELIVERED
-> NAME THE BINDING CONSTRAINT: ASYMMETRY, RIVAL POWER, PARTNER POLITICS OR CAPACITY
-> CLOSE WITH A CALIBRATED WAY FORWARD AND AN EXPLICIT STRATEGIC-AUTONOMY LINK

India-Africa Development and Digital Partnership: LIVE-SOURCE AND DATED-CLAIM BOUNDARY

Live official verification was attempted on 2026-09-03 in the priority order required for this topic: the Ministry of External Affairs pages first, then the Press Information Bureau, then the African Union as the partner multilateral institution. Every outcome is recorded exactly as observed. The Ministry of External Affairs press-release, bilateral-document, country-brief and India-Africa Forum Summit pages returned a browser-requirement stub or the Ministry's own error page, and the Press Information Bureau index returned HTTP 403, so no Indian official item was obtained. The African Union Agenda 2063 overview page did return substantive official text, and it is used here only for the African-owned framework facts it actually states; the African Union document page returned an unrelated climate-forum summary and supplied nothing to this package. The package therefore uses the dated official anchors already carried by the repository owners, each with its actor, exact evidentiary level and date, together with the African Union text just described. It invents no aid, grant or line-of-credit figure, no disbursement or project status, no digital-partnership deployment, coverage or scholarship count, no summit outcome, no memorandum or declaration wording, no institution count, no trade figure, no defence or security development, no date, no previous-year question, no answer key and no current claim.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Central question and the two things this topic is judged on

CENTRAL QUESTION -> is this a donor relationship or a co-development partnership?
JUDGED ON -> human capital and institutions, not infrastructure volume
LIMB 1 -> CAPACITY BUILDING: grant, training positions, joint institutions, students
LIMB 2 -> DIGITAL PARTNERSHIP: Pan African e-Network -> e-VBAB -> SADC MoU pillar
FRAME -> demand-driven, non-intrusive support to democratic institutions
TEST -> does the institution or network still work after the launch ceremony?
BOUNDARY -> trade mechanics to Economy; representation to topic 08; diaspora to topic 09
MUST REMEMBER: India-Africa relations combine political solidarity, capacity-building,...
MUST REMEMBER: India-Africa relations combine political solidarity, capacity-building,...
MUST REMEMBER: India-Africa relations combine political solidarity, capacity-building,...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Summit architecture with exact dates and an honest gap

IAFS-I -> NEW DELHI, 8-9 APRIL 2008 | grant of 500 million USD announced
IAFS-II -> ADDIS ABABA, 24-25 MAY 2011
IAFS-III-> NEW DELHI, 26-29 OCTOBER 2015 | last edition actually held
23 APRIL 2026 -> IAFS-IV announced for New Delhi
21 MAY 2026 -> India and the African Union agree to convene it later
STATUS -> announced and postponed, expressly not held
ANALYTICAL POINT -> programme continuity is not political-architecture continuity

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Capacity-building stack and the figures that must not merge

AFRICA-SPECIFIC -> 1600 training positions under India's technical cooperation programme
GLOBAL TOTAL -> ITEC: more than two lakh persons from over 160 countries
ITEC emphasis recorded by Economic Survey 2025-26: especially the South Asian region
JOINT INSTITUTIONS -> nineteen, built with the African Union Commission and member states
IT | Foreign Trade | Educational Planning and Administration | Diamond Institute
ten vocational training centres | five human settlement institutes
STUDENTS -> at least 10,000 to 15,000 African students in India at any time
TRAP -> quoting the two-lakh ITEC total as an Africa figure is a factual error

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: Digital layer as a dated succession, not a slogan

PAN AFRICAN e-NETWORK -> tele-education and ICT connectivity against the digital divide
-> CONCLUDED 2017 (Ministry of External Affairs record)
-> e-VidyaBharati and e-ArogyaBharati Network Project: the named successor
implementation agreement with Telecommunications Consultants India Limited,
signed 10 September 2018; project launched 2019
-> MEA April 2026 brief: 22 African countries; 15,116 scholarships offered
LIMIT -> scholarships offered is an input measure, not completion or employment
LIMIT -> no continent-wide digital public infrastructure rollout is established

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: The current dated instrument for the digital pillar

2 JULY 2024, SADC SECRETARIAT -> India-SADC MoU on Economic Cooperation signed by
SADC Executive Secretary Elias Mpedi Magosi and India's High Commissioner to
Botswana and Special Representative to SADC, Bharath Kumar Kuthati
RENEWS -> the earlier India-SADC economic-cooperation memorandum of 14 October 1997
FRAMED AGAINST -> SADC's RISDP 2020-2030 and its Digital Transformation Strategy
TEN AREAS -> industrialisation; human and social development; new and emerging
technologies (ICT development, connectivity, access, digital public infrastructure);
trade and investment; disaster risk management; women-led development; private
sector development; space cooperation; green growth; research and innovation
STATUS -> statement of intent; entry into force and delivery need separate verification

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Three gaps that separate announcement from delivery

COMMITMENT	DELIVERY QUESTION	CORRECT WORDING
500 million USD grant	was it disbursed?	announced commitment
190+ LoCs, USD 10 bn	were funds drawn and spent?	extended to 41 countries
19 joint institutions	staffed and functioning?	being established jointly
15,116 scholarships	were they completed?	offered, in 22 countries

RULE -> name the gap explicitly; the marks sit in the distinction, not the number
TRADE BOUNDARY -> USD 81.99 billion in FY2024-25 is scale context, owned by Economy

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Co-development against donor conditionality

PROBLEM -> is India simply another external donor with a template?
RESPONSE: institutions built jointly with the African Union Commission and members
PROBLEM -> does support carry political conditionality?
RESPONSE: non-intrusive support to the development of democratic institutions
PROBLEM -> does non-intrusive mean India is politically absent?
RESPONSE: no, it means engagement without conditionality or prescriptiveness
OPEN QUESTION -> uniform realisation needs country-specific dated evidence

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: The maintenance test as the real measure of long-term

ANNOUNCEMENT -> summit pledge, memorandum signature or launch ceremony
-> CONSTRUCTION or ENROLMENT: the visible first-year output
-> STAFFING, FUNDING and TECHNICAL SUPPORT after the launch
-> CONTINUED USE by the partner institution and its own students or patients
VERDICT -> only the last two steps evidence a long-term institutional partnership
CONSEQUENCE -> answer-writing must cite continuity, not the size of the pledge

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: Security limb with its exact limits

FEBRUARY 2020, LUCKNOW -> first India-Africa Defence Ministers Conclave;
Lucknow Declaration adopted
OCTOBER 2022, GANDHINAGAR -> second India-Africa Defence Dialogue; declaration on
defence and security cooperation
AFINDEX -> Africa-India Field Training Exercise, held in India in 2019 and March 2023
MARITIME -> anti-piracy deployments and capacity cooperation, western Indian Ocean
and the Gulf of Aden
LIMIT -> declarations and offers are not operational capability transfer
LIMIT -> episodic exercises do not create a defence alliance

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: One delivered representation outcome, priced correctly

9 SEPTEMBER 2023, NEW DELHI SUMMIT -> the African Union becomes a permanent member
of the Group of Twenty
WHY IT MATTERS -> partnership language converted into an institutional result
REAL SCALE -> one forum, one seat
NOT RESOLVED -> Africa's financing deficit, implementation deficit and United Nations
representation deficit remain open
USE -> cite as the benchmark for what a realistic representation success looks like
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Africa is not a single actor, African Union membership is not the same...
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Africa is not a single actor, African Union membership is not the same...
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Africa is not a single actor, African Union membership is not the same...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: Political risk and the comparator, without caricature

SAHEL AND WEST AFRICA -> coups in Mali, Guinea, Burkina Faso and Niger, 2020-2023
EFFECT: project delay, higher commercial risk, harder partner selection
ROUTED OBJECTIVE DEMANDS: 2023 Prelims question 98; 2024 Prelims question 91
COMPETING ROUTE -> China's Forum on China-Africa Cooperation and infrastructure finance
INDIA'S COMPARATIVE EDGE -> training, affordable technology, digital public
infrastructure, demand-driven project selection
DISCIPLINE -> do not generalise instability to the continent
DISCIPLINE -> do not assume African states passively choose between India and China
EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Name the country, African or regional...
EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Name the country, African or regional...
EVIDENCE LIMIT: STATUS / LEVELS / IMPLEMENTATION: Name the country, African or regional...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Answer spine tested against Africa's own plan

OPEN -> name the partnership's two limbs and the dated summit framework with its gap
BUILD -> capacity building, joint institutions, digital succession, one dated memorandum
TEST -> commitment against disbursement, announcement against functioning institution
ALIGN -> set the model against Agenda 2063, signed as the 50th Anniversary Solemn
Declaration in May 2013, with its 2013 to 2063 horizon and ten-year implementation
plans, and its Pan-African Vision of an integrated, prosperous and peaceful Africa
CLOSE -> graded verdict on delivery and local ownership; predict no summit or project